

CITY: Pg 3

Gupta orders stricter civic checks ahead of monsoon

NATION: Pg 5

Full Cabinet of new Kerala govt to take oath on May 18: UDF

FILM: Pg 14

‘Cop characters have turned larger-than-life in films’

Jaishankar, Araghchi meet to address Strait of Hormuz shipping delays, energy security

Araghchi says India can play ‘greater role’ for peace in West Asia



External Affairs Minister Dr S Jaishankar, right, interacts with Islamic Republic of Iran's Foreign Minister Seyed Abbas Araghchi during the BRICS Foreign Minister's meeting, in New Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India and Iran held high-level diplomatic talks in New Delhi on Friday, with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi discussing the ongoing US-Iran conflict and its consequences for energy security, maritime trade, and bilateral cooperation — including the future of the strategically vital Chabahar port.

The meeting was the first substantive engagement between the two countries since fighting broke out between Washington and Tehran on February 28. Araghchi was in New Delhi for a three-day visit to attend a BRICS foreign ministers’ conclave.

Jaishankar said the two ministers had “a detailed conversation” covering “the situation in West Asia and its implications,” along with bilateral matters. Central to India’s concerns was the Strait of Hormuz, where several Indian vessels remain stranded, unable to cross the waterway amid Tehran’s blockade. Approximately 20 per cent of the world’s total petroleum supply passes through the strait, making its closure a direct threat to global energy markets.

Araghchi called the meeting “fruitful” and offered India a measure of reassurance. “Iran will always carry out historical duty as protector of security in Hormuz,” he posted on social media, adding that “Iran is a reliable partner of all friendly nations, who can rely on

Continued on P4

SUGGESTS SEPARATE LAND FOR MOSQUE

HC declares Bhojshala site as temple, scraps ASI namaz order



SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: A long-running religious dispute over a mediaeval monument in Madhya Pradesh’s Dhar district reached a landmark turning point on Friday, as the Madhya Pradesh High Court declared the Bhojshala complex a temple dedicated to Goddess Saraswati, handing a decisive victory to the Hindu community that had contested the site’s status for decades.

The Indore bench of the High Court, comprising Justices Vijay Kumar Shukla and Alok Awasthi, ruled that “the religious character of the disputed complex of Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Mosque is established as a temple of Goddess Saraswati”. Along with the declaration, the bench struck down a 2003 Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) order that had permitted Muslims to offer namaz at the complex every Friday. The court also ruled that the Central government and the ASI may now decide on the monument’s administration and management.

The 11th century structure, protected by the ASI, has long been at the centre of competing claims. The Hindu community revered it as a shrine to Vagdevi, another name for Goddess Saraswati, while Muslims referred to it as Kamal Maula Mosque and considered it a place of Islamic worship. A petitioner from the Jain community separately argued that the complex was originally a medieval Jain temple and gurdukul, a traditional centre of learning.

The controversy had prompted the ASI to issue its 2003 arrangement, which allowed Hindus to worship at the site every Tuesday while Muslims offered namaz each Friday. Both provisions drew legal challenge, with the Hindu side pursuing exclusive worship rights through public interest litigations, which the court ultimately accepted on Friday.

The bench, citing the ASI’s scientific survey report and other documents placed before it, noted clear indications

Continued on P4

PM’s brief UAE visit yields \$5 bn fund, oil reserve, LPG supply deal

PM backs safe navigation via Hormuz, condemns attacks on UAE

MPOST BUREAU

ABU DHABI: Though it was a brief visit of Prime Minister Narendra Modi to the United Arab Emirates on Friday, it ended up yielding big returns for India. India and the UAE signed key defence, energy and maritime agreements and announced US\$ 5 billion in investments amid regional geopolitical uncertainty.

PM Modi’s visit resulted in strategic and economic gains for India, with the two countries announcing defence, energy and infrastructure agreements along with substantial investment commitments.

The PM’s visit to Abu Dhabi came at a time of geopolitical churn in West Asia and continued uncertainty in global energy markets. Against the backdrop of the ongoing regional conflict and concerns over disruption to critical shipping routes, including the Strait of Hormuz, both sides stressed the need for stability, connectivity and economic resilience.

PM Modi held wide-ranging talks with UAE President Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan that yielded a landmark defence partnership framework, a \$5 billion investment package, and a clutch of energy agreements - the most substantive outcomes of the first stop on a five-nation diplomatic tour.

The Prime Minister was received at the airport by President Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan and accorded a ceremonial welcome before the two leaders sat down for a series of detailed discussions covering the full breadth of the India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.

At the outset, PM Modi reaffirmed India’s strong condemna-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi being greeted by UAE President Sheikh Mohamed, in Abu Dhabi.

PTI

tion of recent attacks on the UAE and conveyed his country’s solidarity with the UAE’s leadership and people. He also stated India’s clear position in favour of safe transit passage and unimpeded

navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, describing it as vital for regional peace and stability as well as global energy and food security. Energy security was at the core of the substantive agenda.

KEY POINTS

- » India-United Arab Emirates sign defence, energy, maritime, tech agreements
- » \$5 billion UAE investment commitment announced
- » UAE to expand India’s oil reserves to 30 million barrels
- » Plan for strategic gas reserves in India

Ready to extend all possible support for peace and stability in West Asia: PM Modi

MPOST BUREAU

ABU DHABI: India is ready to extend all possible support for the earliest restoration of peace and stability in West Asia, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Friday, as he condemned the attacks on the UAE while praising the Gulf country’s leadership for its handling of the situation with restraint.

During his meeting with UAE President Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed in Abu Dhabi, Modi also assured him that India stands shoulder to shoulder

Continued on P4

The two sides concluded a Strategic Collaboration Agreement between Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited and the Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC),

Continued on P4

CBI arrests NEET 2026 paper leak ‘mastermind’; re-exam on June 21

Pune-based chemistry professor directly dictated the questions, options, and answers to students at his home in late April

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Three days after taking over the investigation into alleged irregularities in the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (Undergraduate) 2026, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) arrested the man believed to be at the heart of the paper leak on Friday — a chemistry professor from Pune who used his insider access to the exam system to dictate actual questions to students who paid lakhs of rupees weeks before the test. On the same day, Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan announced that the cancelled exam will be held again on June 21, and that NEET will

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Kulkarni used his experience as a long-time member of NEET question-setting panels to access and leak the actual exam paper
- » Questions, options and answers were dictated to students in late April; content matched the May 3 exam
- » The leaked material traveled from Pune through a chain of middlemen to Nashik, Gurugram, Jaipur, and Sikar

move to a computer-based format from next year.

Professor P V Kulkarni, a chemistry expert from Latur who had spent years on the panels that set NEET question papers, was arrested from his Pune home after what the

CBI described as a thorough interrogation. “P V Kulkarni has been arrested at Pune after thorough interrogation,” a CBI spokesperson confirmed.

The way the leak worked was straightforward and brazen. In the last week of April,

NEET-UG RE-EXAM: KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- » Re-exam on June 21 (Sunday)
- » Offline (pen-and-paper) mode in 13 languages
- » Exam timing: 2 pm – 5:15 pm (extra 15 mins added)
- » Admit cards & city details by June 14
- » City preference window: May 15–21 (till 11:50 pm)

- » Choose two preferred exam cities

- » If not updated, previous city choice remains

- » Only address & city can be edited

- » No changes after May 21

- » Fees refunded for cancelled test; no extra fee

- » CBT mode from next year

- » Result date not announced yet

Kulkarni called students to his home and dictated questions, options and answers to them. The students wrote everything down in notebooks. When the NEET-UG exam was held on May 3, those notebook entries

Continued on P4

CJI RAISES CONCERNS OVER ACTIVISM AND STANDARDS

Unemployed ‘youngsters like cockroaches’ turn to media, activism; attack system: CJI

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Friday made strong observations in the Supreme Court, criticising certain unemployed youths who, he said, turn to media, social media, or activism “like cockroaches” and begin targeting institutions, as the court heard a petition related to the designation of a lawyer as a senior advocate.

The remarks came during the hearing of a petition linked to the designation of a lawyer as a senior advocate before a bench comprising CJI Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi.



Chief Justice of India Surya Kant

FILE PHOTO

The court reprimanded the petitioner lawyer for aggressively pursuing the senior advocate designation and questioned his

conduct, including the language he allegedly used on Facebook. “The entire world may be eligible to become senior (advocate), but at least you are not entitled,” the bench told the petitioner, PTI reported.

A visibly anguished CJI Surya Kant said that if the Delhi High Court granted senior advocate designation to the petitioner, the Supreme Court would set it aside in view of his professional conduct.

He further remarked, “There are youngsters like cockroaches, who don’t get any employment or have any place in professions. Some of them become media,

some of them become social media, RTI activists and other activists, and they start attacking everyone.”

The bench said the senior advocate designation is a recognition conferred upon a lawyer and not something that should be pursued aggressively.

He said there were already enough “parasites” in society attacking the judiciary, and lawyers should not join hands with them.

During the hearing, the Supreme Court also raised concerns over the authenticity of degrees held by several lawyers.

Continued on P4

Top Court scraps HC order suspending Sengar’s life term in Unnao rape case

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday quashed a Delhi High Court order that had suspended the life sentence of former BJP MLA Kuldeep Singh Sengar in the 2017 Unnao rape case, directing the high court to hear the matter fresh.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi set aside the high court’s decision and asked it to resolve Sengar’s main appeal against his conviction and life imprisonment within two months. If that timeline proves difficult,

Continued on P4

CNG UP BY RS 2

Petrol, Diesel prices hiked by Rs 3 after four-year pause



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: State-owned fuel retailers on Friday hiked petrol and diesel prices by Rs 3 per litre, the first such increase in over four years, as sharply higher global crude oil costs following the Iran war made it impossible for companies to continue absorbing mounting losses.

In New Delhi, petrol now costs Rs 97.77 per litre, up from Rs 94.77, while diesel climbed to Rs 90.67 from Rs 87.67. Petrol and diesel prices are now at their highest levels since May 2022. Prices vary across states depending on local value-added tax rates. In Mumbai, petrol is priced at Rs 106.68 per litre and diesel at Rs 93.14. Kolkata residents will pay Rs 108.74 for petrol and Rs 95.13 for diesel, while Chennai sees petrol at Rs 103.67 and diesel at Rs 95.25 per litre.

Compressed natural gas prices also went up by Rs 2 per kg in Delhi and Mumbai. CNG in Delhi now costs Rs 79.09 per kg, while Mumbai consumers pay Rs 84 per kg. Piped natural gas used in household kitchens and domestic LPG cooking gas prices were left unchanged.

CLOSER LOOK

» Petrol in Delhi: Rs 94.77 → Rs 97.77 per litre

» Diesel in Delhi: Rs 87.67 → Rs 90.67 per litre

» Mumbai: Petrol Rs 106.68, Diesel Rs 93.14

» Kolkata: Petrol Rs 108.74, Diesel Rs 95.13

» Chennai: Petrol Rs 103.67, Diesel Rs 95.25

» CNG price hiked by Rs 2 per kg

» Delhi CNG: Rs 79.09 per kg

» Mumbai CNG: Rs 84 per kg

» No change in PNG (piped gas) and domestic LPG prices

The trigger behind Friday’s revision is a dramatic rise in global crude oil prices, which have surged more than 50 per cent since US-Israeli strikes on Iran on February 28. Tehran’s retaliatory actions disrupted flows through the Strait of Hormuz, one of the world’s most critical oil shipping routes, sending prices climbing steeply.

Despite these pressures, the government had kept retail fuel

Continued on P4

Southwest monsoon likely to set in over Kerala on May 26

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The southwest monsoon is set to reach Kerala on May 26, five days ahead of its usual June 1 arrival date, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) announced on Friday.

“This year, the southwest monsoon is likely to set in over Kerala on May 26 with a model error of ± 4 days,” the IMD said, noting that conditions were already favourable for the monsoon to advance over parts of the South Bay of Bengal, the Andaman Sea, and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands within the next 24 hours. Last year, the monsoon had arrived even earlier, on May 24.

Kerala’s onset traditionally marks the formal beginning of the four-month monsoon season, which runs from June through September, and triggers the system’s gradual northward march across the country. “The advance of the southwest monsoon over the Indian mainland is an important indicator characterising the transition from the hot and dry season to the rainy season,” the IMD said, adding that communities in the monsoon’s path would feel relief from summer heat as it progresses.

The stakes this season are considerable. The monsoon delivers nearly 70 per cent of India’s annual rainfall, sustaining agriculture, replenishing reservoirs and aquifers, and underpinning the broader economy.

This year, however, the IMD has warned that total rainfall could fall short of normal levels. The country is projected to receive around 80 cm of

Continued on P4

AZADPUR

NEET aspirant found dead; family links death to exam cancellation

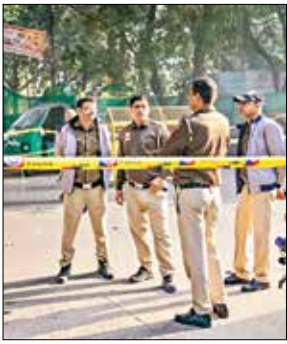
OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 20-year-old NEET aspirant, who had been preparing for the medical entrance test for the past few years, died after allegedly hanging herself at her residence in northwest Delhi's Azadpur, police said on Friday.

Although no suicide note was found at the spot, the deceased's family members suspect that she took the extreme step due to the cancellation of the national entrance test, a senior police officer said.

They also took the body to a crematorium without informing the authorities, claiming that they were unaware of the legal formalities in such cases, the officer said. "The victim was a NEET aspirant. We are probing as to why she took the extreme step. No suicide note has been found during the investigation," the officer said.

On Tuesday, the National Testing Agency (NTA) cancelled the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (Undergraduate), or NEET, held on May 3 amid allegations of



paper leak, leaving about 23 lakh students in the lurch. A re-examination has been scheduled for June 21.

A PCR call was received at the Adarsh Nagar police station on Thursday evening, informing that a woman's body was brought to the Kewal Park Shamshan Ghat for cremation without police intimation.

A police team rushed to the crematorium and found that the deceased was a resident of Lal Bagh in Azadpur, the officer said, adding that the body has been sent to the Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial for an autopsy.

A forensic team has visited the woman's residence

to inspect the scene and collect evidence, he added. Rinku Sharma, a priest at the crematorium, told reporters, "The family members approached us for the cremation of a young woman on Thursday evening. When I asked them the cause of death, they said she had been unwell for the past few days and had died during treatment."

"When I asked for the deceased's Aadhaar card and hospital records, they showed the Aadhaar card but could not furnish any medical documents, raising suspicion."

"When I checked the body, I noticed a mark around the neck that appeared suspicious. Sensing that something was wrong, I informed the police," Sharma said. A maternal uncle of the deceased claimed that the woman had been under stress following the cancellation of the NEET UG 2026.

"She was a bright student and had been preparing for NEET for the past few years. Her parents had told me that she was disturbed after the test was cancelled on Tuesday," he told reporters.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: At least 10 cars and two scooters were gutted when fire broke out at an MCD parking lot in Bihari Colony in the Shahdara area on Friday evening, officials said.

According to the Delhi Fire Services (DFS), a call was received at 4:57 pm, following which four fire tenders were rushed to the spot in East Delhi.

A DFS official said thick black smoke was billowing from the site, which soon turned into a massive blaze engulfing several



parked vehicles.

"At least 10 cars and two scooters were gutted in the fire. Cooling operations were still underway till late evening to ensure that no fresh flare-up took place," the official said.

Firefighters doused the blaze after sustained

efforts, police said.

The fire created panic in the locality as flames rapidly spread from one vehicle to another.

However, officials reported no casualties in the incident.

Police also reached the spot and cordoned off the area to facilitate firefighting opera-

CLOSER LOOK

- » The fire created panic in the locality as flames rapidly spread from one vehicle to another
- » Police reached the spot, cordoned off the area to facilitate firefighting ops and keep onlookers away
- » Officials said a detailed inspection would be carried out after the cooling process is completed

tions and keep onlookers away from the site.

The exact cause of the fire is yet to be ascertained.

Officials said a detailed inspection would be carried out after the cooling process is completed.

Several videos of the

incident surfaced on social media, showing vehicles engulfed in flames and dense smoke rising from the parking area.

In some videos, loud crackling sounds could also be heard as the fire consumed the vehicles.

Man dies after falling into open drain

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A man died after allegedly falling into an open drain in Delhi's Vijay Vihar, police said on Friday.

According to police, a PCR call was received on Friday morning regarding a body lying in an open drain near the ration card office in Budh Vihar Phase-1 area.

A police team rushed to the spot and recovered the body, a police officer said.

The deceased, believed to be



Efforts are underway to establish his identity with the help of local residents

around 30 years old, has yet to be identified. The body has been preserved at a mortuary for post-mortem examination, police said.

Preliminary inquiry suggested that the man may have fallen into the drain during the night and drowned. Police suspect he could

not notice the open drain due to the darkness.

Efforts are underway to establish his identity with the help of local residents and nearby police stations, officials said, adding that further investigation is underway.

Five nabbed for armed robbery

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has arrested five people for allegedly robbing a goldsmith of jewellery and cash at gunpoint in east Delhi and recovered 21 stolen gold chains weighing around 250 grams, officials said on Friday.

The robbery took place on May 3 when Sukumar Dhara, a goldsmith running a shop in Mandawali for over 22 years, was returning home after closing his business. Around 10.30 pm, two armed assailants intercepted him and robbed his scooter carrying 23 gold chains, gold pieces, Rs 3 lakh cash and a mobile phone, police said.

Investigators analysed footage from over 600 CCTV cameras over 10 days as the exact spot was not covered by cameras. Police tracked the accused to a hideout in Jafrabad despite repeated changes of clothes and transport modes to evade surveillance. The arrested accused were identified as Vijay Kumar, Sunil, Arjun, Anand and Harish. PII

IIT Delhi to support digital monitoring, source segregation in MCD waste plan

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is considering a solid waste management plan in collaboration with IIT-Delhi to align the city's waste handling systems with the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026.

Under the proposed plan, the focus would be on source segregation, decentralised processing and digital monitoring of waste movement across the capital.

According to a proposal prepared by the Centre for Rural Development and Technology (CRDT),

The focus would be on source segregation, decentralised processing and digital monitoring of waste

Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT-D), the city generates nearly 11,862 tonnes of municipal solid waste every day within MCD limits, of which 7,641 tonnes, or 64.41 per cent, is processed while the remainder is dumped at landfills.

The estimated project cost has been pegged at Rs 1.94 crore.

The proposal noted that Delhi's total waste process-

ing capacity stands at 8,173 tonnes per day, leaving a significant gap between waste generation and treatment capacity.

The document said the plan seeks to shift Delhi from a "collection-centric" model to a "circular economy" model, in view of the new rules that mandate

four-stream segregation of waste at source -- wet, dry, sanitary and special care

waste -- and place extended responsibility on bulk waste generators to process waste on-site or purchase compliance certificates.

The proposal identified several challenges in Delhi's waste management chain, including limited segregation at source, inadequate tracking of waste movement, insufficient decentralised processing options and the lack of a structured system for handling sanitary and special care waste.

It also flagged concerns over the unorganised nature of waste collectors and rag pickers. PII

Noida Authority orders 20% cut in fuel use for official vehicles

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Noida Authority has decided to cut fuel consumption of its official vehicles and machinery by 20 per cent following Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal for energy conservation amid rising global fuel prices and the ongoing energy crisis triggered by tensions in West Asia.

Officials said the decision was taken in line with the Centre's call for reducing fuel consumption and promoting sustainable practices. The order, issued on Friday by the authority's chief executive officer, Krishna Karunesh, applies to all light and heavy vehicles as well as machines operated by the authority on a daily basis.

According to officials, the move is aimed at ensuring efficient fuel use and supporting national efforts to deal with increasing crude oil prices in the international market.

The authority has directed departments to monitor daily fuel usage and implement measures to ensure the targeted reduction is achieved without affecting essential civic operations.

The initiative comes after PM Modi, while addressing a public gathering in Secunderabad, urged citizens to use public transport, adopt car-pooling and shift towards electric vehicles to reduce dependence on petrol and diesel.

He also appealed to households to cut down edible oil consumption and encouraged farmers to adopt natural farming practices to reduce dependence on imported fertilisers.

Following the Prime Minister's remarks, Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath also appealed to state departments and residents to contribute towards fuel conservation.

Meanwhile, the Centre on Friday increased petrol and diesel prices by Rs 3 per litre across the country, citing pressure from rising global crude oil prices. Officials said the latest measures are part of broader efforts to promote energy efficiency and reduce unnecessary fuel consumption at institutional and public levels.

One killed in Dhaula Kuan DTC bus crash

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 40-year-old man died after being hit by a Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) bus near the Dhaula Kuan Metro Station on Friday morning, while a motorcycle rider sustained minor injuries in the incident, police said.

The deceased was identified as Vijay Singh (40), a resident of Lalu Kheda in Unnao, Uttar Pradesh. Police said a PCR call regarding the accident was received at Dhaula Kuan Police Station, following which local police personnel rushed to the spot and initiated an investigation.

According to investigators, the accident occurred near the exit gate of the Dhaula Kuan Metro Station when Vijay Singh was attempting to cross the road.

During the crossing, he was allegedly struck by an orange-coloured DTC bus passing through the area. The impact of the collision threw him onto the road, causing fatal injuries. He died on the spot before medical assistance could be provided.

A motorcycle rider passing through the area also suffered minor injuries during the incident. Police said the injured biker was given medical assistance and is out of danger.

A Crime Team was called



to inspect the scene and document evidence related to the crash. Officials examined the accident site and recorded details to ascertain the sequence of events leading to the collision.

The body was shifted to Deen Dayal Upadhyay Hospital for preservation and medico-legal formalities. Police said a post-mortem examination would be conducted as part of the legal proceedings.

According to police, the driver of the offending DTC bus fled the spot along with the vehicle immediately after the accident.

Efforts are underway to trace the absconding driver and identify the bus involved in the incident.

Police said legal action has been initiated under relevant provisions of law, and investigators are examining CCTV footage from nearby areas to determine the circumstances surrounding the fatal accident.

OFFERS DIGITAL MAPS, CURATED TOURS...

New 'N郑 Saathi-Delhi Zoo' app aims to make zoo visits interactive & organised

NEW DELHI: With the launch of "N郑 Saathi-Delhi Zoo" app, finding the animal habitat inside the sprawling National Zoological Park has now become as simple as following directions on a smartphone screen.

The "N郑 Saathi-Delhi Zoo" is a mobile application aimed at transforming the zoo-going experience by helping visitors navigate the premises, learn about animals and access facilities without depending on human guides, an official said.

For a first-time visitor stepping inside the zoo's vast green landscape, the app functions almost like a digital companion. From locating an animal enclosure to identifying nearby food courts or drinking water points, the platform combines navigation, information and visitor services in a single interface. One of its key features is an AI Guide Box that responds to visitor queries in real time.



For instance, if a user types, "Where is the Asiatic lion habitat?", the app provides the exact distance of the enclosure and offers options such as "View Animal" and "Navigate".

The application also includes a 2D digital map displaying the location of animals and birds across the zoo along with their distance from the visitor's current point.

Under the "Explore" section, users can browse details about different animals, includ-

ing species information, lifespan, biological details, diet patterns and lesser-known facts about them.

The app also attempts to simplify tour planning through curated routes under the "Plan My Visit" section under which the "Express Tour" is aimed at visitors looking for a quick one-to-two-hour trip through a three-kilometre loop covering over 30 animals.

The "Family Tour" offers a two-to-three-hour route span-

ning six kilometres and covering more than 45 animals. The longer "Explorer Tour", also referred to as the green route, stretches across seven to eight kilometres with 10 stops covering more than 60 animals.

Apart from animal navigation, the application also provides information about public facilities available inside the zoo premises.

Under the "Amenities" section, visitors can locate entry and exit gates, 10 washrooms, drinking water facilities, 13 buggy stops, five food courts, buggy booking centres, first-aid points, baby feeding areas and the education centre.

The app also allows users to purchase zoo tickets online through a login-based booking system. The official said the platform has been designed in both Hindi and English, and includes details about zoo timings, entry tariffs, rules and regulations. PII

announce a cash reward of Rs 50,000 for information leading to his arrest. "The task of tracing Ahmedar was assigned to the crime branch due to the complexity and sensitivity of the case," the officer said.

Ahmedar was apprehended from Anantnag's Fruit and Vegetable Market on May 13 following sustained technical surveillance and source-based inputs. During interrogation, he admitted to severing contact with the complainant after payment disputes and frequently changing SIM cards and residences to evade arrest, police said.

MPOST



Indian Oil Corporation, in collaboration with DMRC and the Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs, on Friday launched two hydrogen-powered shuttle buses in Delhi's Central Vista area to provide zero-emission last-mile connectivity between Central Secretariat and Seva Teerth Metro stations

PII/MPOST

Multispeciality hosp dedicated exclusively to women unveiled

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A multispeciality hospital dedicated exclusively to women has been launched in Nehru Enclave, with its founders saying the facility aims to address gaps in accessible and integrated healthcare for women.

Spread across 30,000 sq ft, The Women's Hospital (TWH) has been designed to provide healthcare services for women across all stages of life, from adolescence to old age, according to a statement by the hospital.

It said that The Women's Hospital has been created to address one of the biggest gaps in Indian healthcare: the absence of one trusted, judgment-free, multispeciality space that understands women's health as a lifelong journey.

The hospital, founded by Anika Parashar and her team with an investment of USD 5 million by investors including The Select Group and Policy Bazaar, will offer services

The Hospital has been created to address one of the biggest gaps in Indian healthcare: the absence of one trusted, judgment-free, multispeciality space

including gynaecology, obstetrics, IVF and reproductive medicine, neonatology, oncology, mental health counselling, endocrinology, cosmetic and reconstructive surgery, gastroenterology, nutrition and physiotherapy.

Parashar said the initiative was aimed at addressing gaps in women's healthcare, which often remains fragmented and delayed.

"TWH has been built to create a healthcare home where women can access specialised, preventive and holistic care

without judgment," she said.

The hospital has 34 beds, including 12 Neonatal Intensive Care Unit (NICU) beds, three modular operation theatres and three labour delivery suites. The statement said the facility has also introduced robotic-assisted surgery, advanced fetal medicine and high-resolution prenatal imaging systems.

Chairman of The Select Group Arjun Sharma said the investment in the hospital reflected the growing need for healthcare spaces focused entirely on women's needs.

The clinical team includes specialists in neonatology, obstetrics and gynaecology, oncology, gastroenterology, urogynecology and radiology.

The hospital said the facility has been designed with patient-focused features such as advanced air purification systems, privacy-led layouts and specialised nutrition plans tailored for pregnancy, recovery and metabolic health.

CIVIC PREPAREDNESS, ENERGY CONSERVATION IN FOCUS AT REVIEW

Gupta orders stricter civic checks ahead of monsoon

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Intensifying the Delhi Government's "Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdan" campaign following Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call for responsible living and energy conservation, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday held a high-level virtual review meeting with District Magistrates and senior officials, directing strict implementation of fuel-saving measures, regular inspections of public facilities and swift action on civic issues ahead of the monsoon season.

The meeting, conducted through video conferencing from the Delhi Secretariat, was attended by the Divisional Commissioner, all District Magistrates and senior officials from multiple departments. During the review, the Chief Minister stressed the need to reduce fuel and electricity consumption while improving administrative efficiency and



Directions were issued for effective implementation of 'No Vehicle Day'

public service delivery. Gupta directed departments to conduct maximum official meetings through online platforms to save "fuel, time and resources". She instructed all departments to ensure at least a 20 per cent reduction in fuel expenses on official vehicles and adopt energy-saving practices in offices. Stressing

the importance of the government's "Metro Monday" initiative, she said officials and employees should use Metro and public transport at least once a week "so that a positive message reaches the public". Directions were also issued for effective implementation of "No Vehicle Day" every week.

The Chief Minister further

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The meet, conducted via video conferencing from the Delhi Secretariat, was attended by the Divisional Commissioner, all DMs and senior officials from multiple depts
- » CM stressed the need to reduce fuel and electricity consumption while improving administrative efficiency and public service delivery

instructed officials to carry out continuous inspections in their respective districts and ensure proper maintenance of Atal Canteens, Arogya Mandirs, fire department offices and other public utility centres. "Common citizens should receive the benefits of government facilities in a timely and organised manner," she said. Review-

ing monsoon preparedness, Gupta directed officials to identify waterlogging-prone areas and take preventive action in advance. She ordered that no drains should remain open and dangerous trees be removed immediately to avoid accidents and inconvenience during the rainy season. Officials were also instructed to speed up work related to PNG connections and provide assistance to residents wherever required.

The Chief Minister also asked officials to regularly share updates regarding development works and corrective measures through social media to ensure transparency in governance. Reaffirming the government's commitment to public participation, Gupta said, "The Delhi Government is committed to turning Prime Minister Modi Ji's 'Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdan' campaign into a large public movement based on people's participation, and not just a government initiative."

MCD reviews monsoon readiness

Schedules inspections of waterlogging hotspots

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Friday held an inter-departmental meeting to review preparations for the upcoming monsoon, with Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar stressing coordination among authorities to prevent waterlogging.

The meeting, held under 'Operation Mission', focused on resolving issues related to waterlogging and desilting of drains ahead of the rains, an official statement said.

According to officials, the objective was to identify and address inter-departmental issues linked to waterlogging and desilting work to ensure effective arrangements before the onset of the monsoon.

"Delhi has 3,014 drains measuring four feet and above, with a combined length of nearly 3,737 kilometres, of which 793 fall under the jurisdiction of the MCD," the commissioner said.

He added that the civic body has completed nearly 65 per cent of the desilting work of its drains ahead of the monsoon season.

The commissioner said the



effectively tackle waterlogging and asked departments to pay special attention to drain merging points, which are prone to water accumulation during heavy rainfall.

He also called on agencies to work in a planned and systematic manner by learning from past experiences and identifying vulnerable locations in advance.

Expressing confidence in the preparedness efforts, the commissioner said better planning and coordination among agencies would help Delhi avoid major waterlogging problems during the upcoming monsoon season.

According to the statement, senior officials of the MCD and representatives from various agencies, including the Public Works Department (PWD), Delhi Jal Board (DJB), Delhi Development Authority (DDA), Delhi Police, Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC), Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC), Irrigation and Flood Control Department and Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DSUB), attended the meeting.

Civic body has completed nearly 65% of the desilting work of drains

PWD is responsible for maintaining 1,375 drains of four feet and above, accounting for around 55 per cent of the total major drains in the city.

He said the MCD has identified 215 drains where inter-departmental coordination is required to address waterlogging and desilting-related issues.

Joint inspections of these drains have been scheduled for May 19, and reports will be submitted to higher authorities by May 21, officials said.

Khurwar said that field-level coordination is essential to

Delhi Medical Council under scanner over ₹5.57 crore loss

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: A Special Audit Report conducted by the Directorate of Audit has uncovered major financial, procedural and administrative irregularities in the functioning of the Delhi Medical Council during the period between December 2019 and February 2025, prompting the Delhi Government to begin scrutiny of accountability and recovery proceedings.

The audit report, submitted to the Health and Family Welfare Department of the Delhi Government, examined alleged violations of the DMC Act, 1997, DMC Rules and General Financial Rules (GFR). Records related to meetings of the Governing Council, Executive Committee and Finance Committee, along with salary payments, allowances, leave encashment, foreign visits, vehicle hiring, medical expenses and administrative expenditures, were scrutinised during the exercise.

'Report examined violations of the DMC Act, '97, DMC Rules and General Financial Rules'

According to the audit findings, the enhancement of the retirement age of the then Registrar from 60 to 65 years was found to be in violation of directions issued by both the Government of India and the Delhi Government. The report also pointed to irregular expenditure on salary and allowances, vehicle hiring, medical reimbursements, telephone expenses and conference participation during the audit period.

The audit observed that the then Registrar was responsible for a loss of more than Rs.5.57 crore to the government exchequer due to reduced renewal fees collected from doctors for registration renewals. It also recommended recovery of over Rs.3.23 crore received as salary,

allowances and related benefits.

Further irregularities amounting to more than Rs.1.24 crore were reportedly linked to regularisation of MTS staff to LDC posts, irregular medical insurance payments for Council members and purchase of costly gift items in violation of prescribed rules. The report additionally recommended recovery of nearly Rs.13 lakh for failure to comply with the mandatory three-month notice period before resignation under DMC provisions. Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said, "The Delhi Government has a zero-tolerance policy towards corruption, financial mismanagement and procedural violations in public institutions."

He added that "transparency, accountability and good governance remain the guiding principles of our government."

The Health Department said the findings were under examination and appropriate action would be taken after due scrutiny.

NEW DELHI: Around 50,000 enumerators will visit households in MCD wards from Saturday, under houselisting phase of Census 2027, officials said. The self enumeration exercise in 250 wards of Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) concluded on Friday, with 1.34 lakh persons submitting census details online, they said.

There are around 30-32 lakh houses in MCD areas. The wards have been mapped into around 46,000 houselisting blocks. Each houselisting block comprises 180-200 houses, an official tasked with Census work said.

To verify the authenticity of census personnel and supervisors, people can check their identity cards and appointment letters, and can also scan the QR code printed on their identity cards, he said.

Self enumeration exercise was already completed in the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) and Delhi Cantt areas. The houselisting phase was also wrapped up in these



Official: Self enumeration exercise was already complete in NDMC area, Delhi Cantt

areas on Friday.

A total of 1,54,127 persons attempted self-enumeration during the exercise between May 1-15, out of which 1,32,840 completed filling their details in the city, barring NDMC and Delhi Cantt areas, according to officials.

The South West district registered the highest number of total self-enumeration cases at 26,475, followed closely by North West at 26,155 and North East at 24,027 cases. Old Delhi district reported the lowest number of total self-enumeration cases at 811, while Outer North recorded 1,155 cases and Central North 3,505 cases. In terms of completed

self-enumerations, South West again topped the list with 23,163 completed cases, followed by North West with 22,661 and North East with 20,762 completed entries.

Old Delhi recorded the lowest number of completed self-enumerations at 659, followed by Outer North with 1,053 and Central North with 3,193 completed cases.

The houselisting exercise will commence with ground-truthing by the enumerators who will verify their houselisting block maps with field visits. This will be followed by door-to-door survey under houselisting phase. It will conclude on June 14.

AAP raises concerns over fuel price hike

NEW DELHI: The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Friday expressed concern over the Rs 3 per litre hike in petrol and diesel prices, saying rising fuel costs and economic pressures were affecting common people.

Addressing a press conference, AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj said the increase could add to household burdens and raised concerns over inflation, unemployment and the country's economic situation.

He said the government should place the economic situation before the public and added that fuel prices may continue to fluctuate depending on global developments.

Responding to the remarks, Delhi BJP spokesperson Praveen Shankar Kapoor said fuel prices were linked to international crude oil trends and global economic factors.

Ministers take Metro and EVs to push fuel-saving campaign

NEW DELHI: As part of the Delhi Government's push for fuel conservation and sustainable mobility, several ministers on Friday adopted public transport and electric vehicles to promote Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call for responsible energy use amid rising global fuel concerns.

PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh arrived at an event at the NDMC office on a battery-powered bicycle, describing the move as a symbolic but necessary step towards fuel conservation. He said responsible governance must be reflected not only in policies but also in personal conduct. "The Prime Minister's message is the need of the hour. The more we save today, the more secure our future will be," he said, urging citizens to reduce fuel consumption.



tion and make greater use of public transport.

The minister also reiterated the Delhi Government's advisory encouraging work-from-home arrangements wherever possible to reduce traffic congestion and fuel usage.

Meanwhile, Delhi Minister for Art, Culture & Languages, Tourism and Labour Kapil Mishra drove an electric vehicle to the Delhi Secretariat to spread awareness about energy conservation. He said initiatives such as "Metro Monday", promotion of EVs,

two days of work from home, and reduced use of private vehicles were being actively encouraged under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. Mishra added that several traders and industrialists in Delhi had expressed support for implementing work-from-home and EV policies.

Industries and Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa also joined the campaign by travelling to the Delhi Secretariat using the Metro and an electric vehicle under the "Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdaan" initiative. Sirsa said smaller official convoys, public transport, and EV adoption were essential to reduce fuel consumption, ease the economic burden caused by rising crude oil prices, and strengthen India's self-reliance.

MPOST

GDA clears ₹2,813 cr Aerocity proj near Raj Nagar Extension

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: The 172nd board meeting of the Ghaziabad Development Authority (GDA) on Thursday cleared a series of mega urban infrastructure and housing projects worth thousands of crores, including an Aerocity near Raj Nagar Extension, an international cricket stadium, expansion of the Harmandipuram housing scheme and advanced fire safety systems for high-rise buildings.

The meeting, chaired by Meerut divisional commissioner and GDA board chairman Bhanu Chandra Goswami, discussed 13 major development agendas aimed at long-term urban expansion and infrastructure growth in the city. Key proposals related to Aerocity, sports infrastructure, group housing, land-use changes, model zoning reg-



ulations-2025 and high-tech township projects received approval. Among the biggest announcements was the approval of the Aerocity project over nearly 200.25 hectares in Merta, Ataur and Mevla Agri villages near Raj Nagar Extension. The board sanctioned an estimated budget of Rs 2,813 crore for the project. Land acquisition will be carried out through land pooling, mutual agreement purchases and acquisition under statutory provisions. Officials said the Aerocity will feature residential sectors, commercial

hubs, hotels, convention centres, entertainment zones and modern civic infrastructure.

The board also approved the development of an international cricket stadium under a joint venture model between GDA and the Uttar Pradesh Cricket Association (UPCA), with both entities sharing equal participation in construction, operations and land development. Officials said the stadium project is expected to create a larger sports and hospitality ecosystem capable of hosting national and international matches. The board also approved Rs 2,179.5 crore for the second phase of the Harmandipuram housing scheme across 125.28 hectares. It further cleared procurement of a 102-metre hydraulic rescue platform, for which GDA has transferred Rs 100 crore to the UP Fire and Emergency Services department.

In February 2026, chief minister Rekha Gupta announced that the Delhi government would issue 2 lakh fresh ration cards this year.

Earlier this year, the Delhi government's Food Supply and Consumer Affairs Department undertook a verification drive, and notices were issued to 2.76 lakh ration card holders.

Just over 1,000 ration card holders had replied to the notices, officials said.

Applicants have been asked to check the "pending for submission" section under the "apply online" menu in their e-District login to review and complete the resubmission process.

The move is expected to help clear the backlog of pending applications while ensuring that all submissions are supported by updated income documentation, officials said.

SWAMI DAYANAND HOSPITAL

Mayor announces 100-bed critical care unit

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Praveesh Wahi on Friday said a new 100-bed Critical Care Unit equipped with ICU and emergency operation theatre facilities will be constructed at Swami Dayanand Hospital.

The announcement was made during the mayor's inspection of the hospital in Dilshad Garden, where he reviewed patient facilities, sanitation and preparedness amid prevailing heatwave conditions.

Speaking during the visit,



Wahi said the upcoming unit under the 'Pradhan Mantri Ayushman Bharat'-Health Infrastructure Mission, would strengthen healthcare infrastructure in east Delhi and reduce the need for referrals to other hospitals.

He said the new facility

would include an Intensive Care Unit (ICU), Nursery, Pediatric Intensive Care Unit (PICU) and an emergency operation theatre.

"The construction of the Critical Care Unit (CCU) will enable residents of east Delhi to access better medical treat-

ment closer to their homes," Wahi added.

During the inspection, the mayor also inaugurated a newly constructed air-conditioned waiting room for attendants of patients and directed officials to install additional benches for public convenience.

According to officials, around 4,000 patients visit the hospital's OPD daily. The mayor reviewed arrangements made to tackle heatwave conditions, including additional beds, ORS availability and cooling facilities, and directed officials to further strengthen sanitation measures at the hospital.

Wahi also instructed officials to improve accommodation arrangements for nursing staff, install water sprinklers in the hospital park and operationalise air coolers after proper cleaning.

The construction of the Critical Care Unit (CCU) will enable residents of east Delhi to access better medical treatment closer to their homes



UNIVERSITY OF JAMMU

OFFICE OF DEAN RESEARCH STUDIES

(NAAC Accredited 'A++' Grade University)



NOTIFICATION

Ph.D. Admissions (Session: April, 2026)

Online applications from eligible candidates are invited for admission to Ph.D Programme for the Session: April, 2026, as per vacancies available in various departments of the University. The candidates are required to apply only after ensuring their eligibility and availability of the seats in respective departments alongwith specialization, if any.

The applications are open w.e.f. April 30, 2026, and the last date of online application submission is May 25, 2026. Further, admissions shall be made strictly as per the Statutes governing the whole-time/Part-time Ph.D Programme of University of Jammu as shall be applicable from time to time. Only online applications shall be considered for the purpose of admissions. Detailed notification vindicating eligibility and other related details, can be accessed at University Website: www.jammuuniversity.ac.in

For any query/clarification please feel free to contact at 0191-2435248, 2435259 (Ext. 2260; 2236)

No. DRS/ADM/26/718
Dated: 29-04-2026

DIP No:DIP/J-644-P/26

Sd/-
Professor Neelu Rohmetra
Dean Research Studies

STRESSES IMPORTANCE OF UNMANNED AIRCRAFT IN MODERN WARS

‘Cheap attacks, costly defences’: Air Chief highlights drone warfare challenges

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: On Friday, Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh spoke about the experience that India faced with threats from the sky, adding that India had done well since it had a coordinated structure and a system that had been integrated into the military operations.

He reiterated that in order to tackle the threat of unmanned aerial vehicles, it was essential to have centralised command, domain awareness and integration across all branches of the armed forces.

Further, he stressed the importance of unmanned aircraft in modern wars while stating that the need for humans in decision-making processes on battlefields will still be required in the coming years.

Speaking at an event attended by senior veterans, defence forces, academics and private industries in the national

Highlights

- » Regarding counter-drone operations, Singh said that the art of warfare had now become a continuous struggle between offensive and defensive technologies
- » Singh highlighted the increasingly contentious issue surrounding cost-effectiveness of drones and the costly systems used to combat them

capital, the Air Chief Marshal mentioned that unmanned aerial systems (UAS) are an “extension of air power” and that all rules that apply to air power apply to UAS as well. While discussing the evolution of modern warfare, he said that “there are no more empty skies” and that recent wars around the globe have proved that UAVs and

other autonomous systems play a key role in modern wars.

Regarding counter-drone operations, Singh said that the art of warfare had now become a continuous struggle between offensive and defensive technologies.

He pointed out that every new technological advancement, by its very nature, was followed by the creation of counter-technological devices. In his view, this trend guaranteed that one side would not have an upper hand for too long.

Singh further highlighted the increasingly contentious issue surrounding the cost-effectiveness of drones and the costly systems used to combat them. Although he did concede that there were worries about “cheap attacks and costly defences”, he insisted that the actual cost involved was not only the cost of the weapon but rather the extent of damage it could cause. Consequently, he

believed that nations should have a practical and cost-effective solution in place.

Speaking about the possibility of the war being fought only through manned or unmanned means, Singh was optimistic that the future would see a partnership between manned and unmanned systems. In his view, it was difficult to imagine a time when man would have nothing to do in wars as far as the next couple of decades were concerned.

In reference to global military advancements, he emphasised the point that nations were still spending millions on developing manned combat systems despite rapid progress in the development of unmanned systems. The Air Chief Marshal pointed out that survivability was one of the critical challenges facing unmanned combat platforms during wartime situations. Though these systems

can play a useful role in peacetime for surveillance purposes, many were vulnerable to attacks in wartime.

Expanding on his earlier comments about airpower, Air Chief Marshal Singh further explained that autonomous systems are also being introduced into maritime and terrestrial battlefields. The use of unmanned surface vehicles, robotic combat technology, and many other advanced systems that are revolutionising the conduct of warfare all around the world was cited by him as an example. But at the same time, he cautioned that the lack of regulatory measures might pose significant operational problems.

In order to expedite the process of innovation and manufacturing of weapons systems, there is a need for cooperation between the armed forces, industry, academia, and research institutes.

K’taka: 7 killed as tractor plunges off bridge; CM announces compensation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOPPAL: Seven people, among them a one-year-old boy, were killed and 12 others injured after a lorry collided with a tractor near a bridge in Koppal district on Friday, police said.

The impact caused the tractor to lose control and plunge off the bridge, resulting in the casualties, they said.

Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah announced a compensation of Rs 5 lakh each to the families of the deceased on humanitarian grounds.

Taking to X, the CM said he was deeply saddened to learn about the tragic incident in which a tractor carrying devotees to the Huligemma temple fell from the Tungabhadra bridge, resulting in the loss of lives, including children.

“I pray that the departed souls attain eternal peace and wish those injured in the accident a speedy recovery as they undergo treatment,” he said.

The CM said he had spoken to MP Tukaram regarding the accident and obtained details

Karnataka Chief Minister announced a compensation of Rs 5 lakh each to the families of the deceased on humanitarian grounds

of the incident.

“All the deceased belonged to poor families, and these deaths have pushed them into further hardship. In this context, compensation of Rs 5 lakh each will be provided to the bereaved families on humanitarian grounds,” he added.

The accident occurred on the Tungabhadra bridge under the jurisdiction of Munirabad police station.

The victims were residents of Yashwanth Nagar in Sandur taluk and Marlayanahalli village in Kudligi taluk, they added.

According to police, the tractor carrying 19 passengers was headed to the Huligemma

temple when the accident took place.

Citing preliminary findings, Koppal Superintendent of Police Ram L. Arasiddi said the lorry allegedly rammed the tractor, causing it to veer off the bridge.

Six passengers died on the spot, while 12 others sustained injuries. Later, one more person succumbed to injuries, taking the death toll to seven, he said. The injured are undergoing treatment at various hospitals. Further investigation is underway.

Congress MP E. Tukaram also visited the hospital where the injured were being treated.

BJP state president B. Y. Vijayendra termed the accident “horrific” and urged the state government to provide assistance and the best possible treatment to the injured.

“The fact that poor daily wage labourers have become victims of this tragedy has intensified the pain even further. I express my deepest condolences to the families of the deceased,” he said in a post on X.

From Page 1

PM’s brief UAE

under which the UAE will enhance its participation in India’s Strategic Petroleum Reserves to 30 million barrels. The two nations also agreed to work together to establish strategic gas reserves in India. A separate arrangement between Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL) and ADNOC on long-term LPG supplies was also formalised.

Both leaders acknowledged the UAE’s role as an important and enduring partner in India’s energy security, including crude oil, LNG, and LPG supplies, and agreed to promote new initiatives for a comprehensive energy partnership going forward. The UAE was a roughly two-and-a-half-hour stopover for the prime minister, following which he left for the Netherlands.

During the meeting, the two leaders inked strategic collaborations in broadly seven areas.

“This UAE visit also saw the conclusion of key agreements across vital areas such as energy, defence, infrastructure, shipping and advanced technology, giving fresh impetus to the India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership,” Modi said on social media.

“In another important development, UAE announced investments worth USD 5 billion in India. This will further deepen economic ties,” he said. According to the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA), the Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited – a public sector company responsible for maintaining the country’s strategic petroleum reserves – has signed a deal with the Abu Dhabi National Oil Co aimed at “strategic collaboration”.

It is aimed at energy security, “enhancing India’s petroleum reserves and potential cooperation on Liquid Natural Gas and Liquid Petroleum Gas (LPG) storage facilities,” it said. The two leaders also signed a strategic collaboration pact in LPG, aimed at long-term supply of the most widely used cooking fuel in India, economic stability and energy partnership.

They also signed a framework for strategic defence partnership aimed at strengthening defence industrial collaboration, boosting innovation and sharing of technology, and strengthening national and regional security, the MEA said.

The fourth collaboration concerns the setting up of a ship repair centre in Gujarat’s Vadinar and to boost ports and coastal infrastructure, while the fifth one concerns an arrangement on skill development in ship repair, the ministry said.

The sixth one is about setting up a supercomputer cluster to bolster India’s AI ambitions and the seventh one is a USD 5 billion investment commitment to create stronger markets and more jobs. “It underscores UAE’s sustained commitment to India’s development and growth story,” the MEA said.

Friday’s discussions also revolved around the blue economy, technology including fintech, defence and people-to-people ties among others. All of these were wrapped up in around two and a half hours. While leaving, Modi said: “Concluding a short but highly productive visit to the UAE. Held extensive discussions with

my brother. His Highness Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, on ways to further deepen the India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership. I am confident that the outcomes of this visit will further strengthen our friendship and contribute to growth and prosperity.”

“In the field of investment, the UAE has traditionally been a significant investor in India. It is cumulatively the seventh-largest investor in India over the course of the last 25 years,” India’s Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri said. (WITH AGENCY INPUTS)

PM Modi

with the UAE in every situation and will continue to do so in the future.

Underlining that the impact of the volatile situation in West Asia is being felt across the globe, Modi said India has always given priority to dialogue and diplomacy to resolve the issues.

PM Modi also conveyed India’s clear position in favour of ensuring safe transit passage and unimpeded navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, which is vital for enduring regional peace and stability, as well as energy and food security.

He said that keeping the Strait of Hormuz free, open and safe is our highest priority and added that adherence to international laws is essential. Iran shut down the Strait of Hormuz, a key waterway between the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman, following the launch of the US-Israeli attacks on February 28.

The UAE, which hosts a US military base, has been at the receiving end of Iranian strikes during the ongoing US-Israeli war on Iran.

Modi and Mohamed bin Zayed held a series of detailed discussions, during which the Prime Minister reaffirmed India’s strong condemnation of the attacks on the UAE, as well as its solidarity with the leadership and the people of the Gulf country. “We strongly condemn the attack that took place in the UAE. The way the UAE was targeted is unacceptable in any form,” Modi said, without naming any country.

Last week, three Indian nationals were injured after a fire broke out on the Fujairah Petroleum Industries Zone (FOIZ) in the UAE following a drone strike. The UAE’s Ministry of Defence blamed Iran for the attack.

“In these difficult circumstances, the restraint, courage and wisdom demonstrated by you are highly commendable,” Modi told the UAE president. Modi also thanked him for taking care of the Indian community like members of his own family in such challenging times.

The ongoing conflict in West Asia has heightened concerns in India over potential disruptions to crude oil and gas supplies, particularly through the Strait of Hormuz. (WITH AGENCY INPUTS)

Petrol, Diesel prices hiked

prices frozen at two-year-old levels, citing the need to protect price-sensitive consumers from the global energy shock. Critics, however, pointed to political calculations, as several state assembly elections were underway. The price revision came through only after voting concluded, following the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party’s expanded influence after winning three of five states, includ-

ing West Bengal. The BJP defended the decision, saying the government had shielded ordinary consumers from global oil prices for over two months and that the increase of 3.2 to 3.4 per cent was “limited and calibrated.” But Congress leader Rahul Gandhi was sharply critical. “Ghalti Modi sarkaar ki, keemat janta chukayegi,” he wrote on X, which translates to: the public will pay the price for the Modi government’s mistake. Gandhi suggested further price increases were coming, describing the Rs 3 hike as an initial shock with the rest of the “vasooli,” or recovery, to follow in instalments.

The last time petrol and diesel prices were raised was in April 2022. The only movement since had been a one-time reduction of Rs 2 per litre on both fuels in March 2024, ahead of the Lok Sabha elections.

Even with Friday’s revision, industry insiders say oil companies are far from recovering their full costs. According to Crisil estimates, cumulative losses since the start of the conflict are expected to cross Rs 1 lakh crore by end of May. After accounting for excise duty relief announced by the government in March and the latest price hike, under-recoveries stand at around Rs 10 per litre on petrol and Rs 13 on diesel. Private fuel retailers had moved ahead of state companies.

Nayara Energy, the country’s largest private fuel retailer, had raised petrol prices by Rs 5 and diesel by Rs 3 per litre in March. Shell went further, increasing petrol by Rs 7.41 and diesel by Rs 25 per litre from April 1. In Bengaluru, Shell currently sells petrol at Rs 119.85 and diesel at Rs 123.52 per litre. On LPG, oil companies are losing Rs 674 per 14.2-kg cylinder even after a Rs 60 per cylinder price increase in March.

The fuel price revision comes as the government rolls out broader measures to contain India’s swelling oil import bill. Prime Minister Narendra Modi this week urged fuel conservation, work-from-home practices and reduced travel. Several state governments have instructed departments to cut down on travel and physical meetings.

The macroeconomic concern is real. India’s retail inflation based on the Consumer Price Index rose to 3.48 per cent in April 2026 from 3.40 per cent in March, while wholesale price inflation surged to 8.3 per cent, a 42-month high, driven largely by food and energy costs. Economists note that while petrol and diesel are captured within broader CPI categories rather than as standalone items, their indirect impact through freight, logistics and input costs spreads across nearly every sector of the economy.

Jaishankar

safety of commerce.” At a subsequent press briefing, he said he hoped the strait would be “fully reopened soon,” though he clarified that vessels belonging to countries “fighting with us” remained barred from passage. He attributed the crisis to “US aggression” and argued that the waterway, which lies in the territorial waters of Iran and Oman, should be managed by those two countries alone.

Araghchi praised India’s neutral stance in the conflict and said the country “can play a greater role in this region to help diplomacy and to promote peace and security,” describing India as “a friend to all countries in the Persian Gulf.”

“I think India, with its good reputation, (India) can play a greater

role in this region to help (bring) peace; to promote peace and security,” he said, answering a question.

“We will appreciate any positive (and) constructive role played by India in this region,” the Iranian foreign minister said.

Chabahar port also featured prominently in the discussions. The sanctions waiver that allowed India to continue work at the port expired on April 26, and New Delhi did not allocate funds for the project in this year’s Union Budget. India has so far invested around \$120 million in equipment procurement for the terminal. Araghchi called Chabahar “one of the symbols of cooperation between Iran and India” and expressed hope that India would continue its involvement, describing the port as “a golden gate” for Indian access to Central Asia, the Caucasus and Europe. The Iranian foreign minister also said that Tehran is ready to provide India with energy resources if the country is ready to procure them.

“India has been a customer of Iranian oil in the past. It (procurement of crude oil) has been stopped by India because of the illegal and unilateral sanctions by the US,” he said. “We are obviously interested to continue our business in oil and energy and we are ready to sell our to India. We do understand their considerations and we do understand the consequences of the sanctions imposed by the US,” he added.

Araghchi said it for the Indian government to decide whether to restore its energy ties with Iran.

“We have no problem; it is up to the Indian government to decide but I believe that once the sanctions are lifted, we will immediately go back to the same volume of trade we had with each other before the sanctions were imposed (on Iran),” he said.

“We used to have more than USD 20 billion of trade with India. Now it is much smaller but still in billions of dollars,” he said.

Totally false

Emphasising that the Centre is trying to shield people from the adverse impact of the ongoing West Asia conflict, Modi had on May 10 called for a judicious use of fuel and postponement of gold purchases, among other measures, to strengthen the economy.

CBI arrests NEET

“tallied exactly” with the actual paper. Students had paid several lakh rupees each to attend these sessions. A woman named Manisha Waghmare, arrested by the CBI on May 14, had helped Kulkarni bring these students together.

From Kulkarni’s sessions, the leaked material then passed through a chain of middlemen. Waghmare gave the paper to one Dhananjay Lokhande, who was arrested from Ahilyanagar on Thursday. Lokhande passed it to Nashik-based Shubham Khairnar. Khairnar passed it further to Yash Yadav in Gurugram, who then circulated it more widely.

In another branch of the same network, Khairnar told Yadav in April that a Jaipur man named Mangilal Biwal was willing to pay Rs 10 to 12 lakh for leaked questions for his younger son. Khairnar reportedly shared 500 to 600 questions with Yadav, which investigators say was enough to score well and secure a seat in a good medical college. The final deal between Yadav and Mang-

ilal Biwal was settled at Rs 10 lakh. Mangilal then shared the material with his son and also distributed it among relatives. Yadav additionally asked Vikas Biwal, Mangilal’s elder son, to find more NEET aspirants willing to buy the questions, so that some of the money paid could be recovered. Vikas knew Yadav from a NEET coaching centre in Sikar, Rajasthan.

The CBI has so far arrested eight people in the case: Mangilal Biwal, Vikas Biwal and Dinesh Biwal from Jaipur; Yash Yadav from Gurugram; Shubham Khairnar from Nashik; Dhananjay Lokhande from Ahilyanagar; Manisha Waghmare from Pune; and now Professor Kulkarni, also from Pune. In the 24 hours before Friday, CBI teams searched multiple locations across the country and seized documents, mobile phones and electronic devices. “A detailed forensic and technical analysis of the seized items is going on,” the spokesperson said. Investigators have already recovered incriminating chats and digital copies of the leaked paper from the seized devices, and plan to extract deleted data through forensic examination.

At a press conference in Delhi on Friday, Education Minister Pradhan spoke directly to the millions of students affected by the cancellation. “Our topmost priority is the future of the students. I want to appeal to the society, especially to all students, to appear in the examination without fear. The government stands with you. We will not let malpractice happen this time,” he said.

Pradhan explained how the government came to know about the leak. After the May 3 exam, students began filing complaints on the NTA’s grievance portal by May 7, flagging that questions from circulating “guess papers” had appeared in the actual exam. A preliminary inquiry was started immediately. The case was handed to central agencies on the night of May 7 itself, and over the next few days, as evidence confirmed that questions had indeed leaked, the government cancelled the exam on May 12. “We did not want any deserving student to be deprived of their rights because of the conspiracy of the education mafia or because of an undeserving candidate benefiting through unfair means,” the minister said. Pradhan also acknowledged that this was not the first time NEET had faced such a crisis. Following irregularities in 2024, the Radhakrishnan Committee was set up and its recommendations were put in place. “Despite that, this incident occurred,” he said.

For students now waiting for the re-exam, here is what has been announced. The exam will be held on June 21, from 2 pm to 5:15 pm, which is 15 minutes longer than the original slot. It will remain a pen-and-paper test across 13 languages. Admit cards will be out by June 14. Students can update their address and choose a preferred exam city on the NTA website between May 15 and May 21 until 11:50 pm. Those who do not make changes will keep their earlier city choice. No other changes to application details will be allowed, and no requests will be accepted after May 21. The government also said it will talk to state governments about arranging transport for students, and the NTA is keeping weather conditions in mind given the June date.

Looking ahead, Pradhan confirmed that from next year NEET will be conducted in computer-based mode. “The CBT mode of exam is comparatively better than OMR. It is a bit protected,” he said, while noting that the country will need to stay

alert to the growing challenges of cybercrime.

His warning to those who might try to disrupt the re-exam was direct. “To those creating fear and disturbances, stay away from the upcoming examination process. Otherwise, they will have to face punishment,” he said. On the CBI investigation, he added: “Whether someone is within the NTA or outside it, no one will be spared.” For the lakhs of honest students who now have to sit the exam a second time through no fault of their own, that assurance from the government is what they will be holding on to on June 21.

HC declares

of a Sanskrit teaching centre and a temple of Goddess Saraswati within Bhojshala. The court also connected the structure to King Bhoj of the Parmar dynasty, a Rajput kingdom that governed the Malwa region of present-day central India between the 9th and 14th centuries.

The ASI’s survey, which was ordered by the High Court on March 11, 2024, began on March 22 and concluded after 98 days. The agency submitted its report, running to over 2,000 pages, to the court on July 15 of that year. The report indicated that a massive structure predating the mosque existed at the site during the reign of the Parmar kings and that the current structure was built using repurposed temple components. The Hindu petitioners pointed to coins, sculptures, and inscriptions uncovered during the survey as further proof of the complex’s original character as a temple.

The court observed that the Bhojshala-Kamal Maula Mosque site is protected under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958, and that this protection applies retrospectively from March 18, 1904, in line with earlier heritage laws. On this basis, it held that the disputed structure is to be understood in its original religious context as Bhojshala, a temple dedicated to Goddess Saraswati.

Rejecting the Muslim community’s reliance on a 1935 Ailan issued by the former Dhar State declaring the structure a mosque, the court noted that the Government of India Act, 1935 came into force only in April 1937. Since the proclamation predates the operative legal framework, the court found it legally untenable and insufficient to determine the site’s status.

The Muslim side, however, contested the findings, arguing in court that the survey report was biased and prepared to support the Hindu petitioners’ claims. The ASI responded by stating that the survey had been conducted with expert assistance, including three specialists from the Muslim community.

The court, in its ruling, also addressed the Muslim community’s access to a place of worship. It said that if the Maulana Kamaluddin Welfare Society, the Muslim party in the case, applies to the state government for land in Dhar district to construct a mosque, the government may consider the request in accordance with applicable legal provisions. The court also directed the Union government to initiate steps to bring back the idol of Goddess Saraswati currently kept in a museum in London. The idol has been in the United Kingdom since it was taken there in the late 19th century. The court further ordered that, once returned, the idol should be reinstalled at the Bhojshala complex.

Monsoon

rain during the monsoon months, below the long-period average of 87 cm recorded between 1971 and 2020. The likely shortfall is being linked to El Niño. In its monthly forecast issued on May 1, the department said that ENSO-neutral conditions over the equatorial Pacific were shifting toward El Niño, a climate pattern historically associated with reduced rainfall across India.

Top Court

the bench said the high court should at least pass an order on Sengar’s plea for suspension of sentence before the summer vacation begins.

“Without expressing any opinion on merits, we allow the appeal and set aside the impugned order,” the bench said. It also instructed the high court to decide the suspension plea afresh, hearing all parties including the victim, without being guided by the Supreme Court’s observations.

The case had drawn sharp public attention in December last year after the Delhi High Court suspended Sengar’s jail term, noting he had already served seven years and five months in prison. That order triggered protests from the victim, her family, and rights activists. The Supreme Court stepped in on December 29, staying the high court’s decision and directing that Sengar remain in custody.

At the heart of the legal dispute is whether an elected MLA qualifies as a “public servant” under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act. The Delhi High Court had ruled that Sengar, convicted under Section 5(C) of POCSO for aggravated penetrative sexual assault by a public servant, did not meet the definition of a “public servant” under Section 21 of the IPC. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the CBI, argued the high court’s interpretation was flawed and pointed to the Supreme Court’s ruling in the L. K. Advani case, which held that anyone holding public office, including MPs and MLAs, is deemed a public servant. Justice Bagchi responded that the court was “not endorsing the hypertechnical view taken by the high court,” noting that the POCSO Act exists to protect children.

Senior advocate N. Hariharan, representing Sengar, contended that the survivor was not a minor at the time of the alleged incident, a claim the CBI firmly opposed.

Sengar continues to remain in jail as he is also serving a 10-year sentence in the custodial death case of the victim’s father, for which no bail has been granted.

CJI

The CJI said the court was considering asking the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) to verify the degrees of many lawyers wearing black coats because of serious doubts regarding their genuineness.

The court further remarked that the Bar Council of India would not act on the issue because “they need their votes”.

Following the court’s observations, the petitioner apologised to the bench and sought permission to withdraw the petition. The bench allowed the withdrawal plea.

Won't pass order in favour of mining lease holders for now: SC

According to the hospital administration, all four newborns are currently under observation. One of the babies is stable and normal, while two others require special medical care. The first baby born is being fed with the mother's milk and is said to be stable.



In a post on X, Union Environment Minister Bhupendra Yadav commended the “tech-led conservation” effort, saying,

The WII said the bridges were designed as to mitigate the impact of electrification works on the existing single-track Lumding-Dibrugarh railway line passing through the sanctuary, during February-

He claimed that Rs 2,263 crore in negative FSA surplus due to consumers since 2021 had not been passed on, while pending subsidies of Rs 1,971 crore had worsened DISCOMs' financial condition. **MPO**

NEW DELHI: The Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune, on Friday inaugurated a dedicated Incubation Centre for Startups in Weather and Climate, in a move aimed at opening up India's meteorological services to private-sector innovation. The launch coincided with the one-day Weather and Climate Innovation Meet for Startups and Entrepreneurs, held under the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES). The facility was inaugurated by MoES secretary M. Ravichandran, in the presence of Shailesh Naik, Director of the National Institute of Advanced Studies and former Secretary, MoES, and Suryachandra Rao, Director of IITM. The centre forms a core component of the National Enterprise for Atmospheric Technology (NEAT), a vertical of the MoES's flagship Mission Mausam programme.

Responding swiftly, Army personnel launched relief and rescue operations in the affected area despite sub-zero winds, slippery roads and continuous adverse weather, officials said. Stranded tourists were provided medical assistance, warm refreshments, food, drinking water and logistical support until vehicular movement could be restored, they said.

He said the Haryana government had made special arrangements with the Railways to ensure safe and comfortable travel for devotees. Earlier, a special train was sent to Ayodhya Dham, while the first train under the scheme departed from Kurukshetra on May 5.



EDITORIAL
CUSHIONING
THE CONSUMER

The Rs 3 per litre increase in petrol and diesel prices announced on May 15 has understandably unsettled households already grappling with rising living costs. For the average commuter, truck driver, farmer, or small business owner, fuel is not an abstract economic variable; it is woven into daily survival. Every increase at the fuel station eventually echoes through transport costs, vegetable prices, school bus fares, and household budgets. Yet, even amid public frustration, it is important to understand the extraordinary geopolitical and economic circumstances behind the decision — and the larger balancing act India is currently attempting.

The present crisis is not rooted in domestic mismanagement alone, nor is it comparable to ordinary inflationary cycles. The trigger lies thousands of kilometres away in West Asia, where escalating tensions involving Iran and disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz have shaken global energy markets. The Strait remains one of the world's most critical oil arteries, carrying nearly a fifth of globally traded crude. Any instability there instantly rattles importing nations, especially countries like India that depend heavily on overseas energy supplies. India imports roughly 80 to 85 per cent of its crude oil requirements. That dependence leaves little room for insulation when global oil prices surge sharply.

What distinguishes India's response from many major economies, however, is the extent to which the government and public sector oil companies delayed passing on the burden to consumers. For nearly 76 days, retail prices remained largely unchanged despite crude oil reportedly crossing the psychologically significant \$100 per barrel mark. During this period, oil marketing companies absorbed mounting under-recoveries running into nearly Rs 1,000 crore per day. Estimates suggest petrol under-recoveries climbed to around Rs 26 per litre and diesel to an alarming Rs 82 per litre. No energy-importing country can indefinitely sustain such losses without eventually recalibrating prices.

Critics may argue that even a modest hike hurts the poor disproportionately, and they are not wrong. Fuel demand in India is largely price inelastic. A farmer cannot suddenly stop using diesel-powered irrigation pumps. Truckers cannot abandon highways. Auto-rickshaw drivers cannot suspend work because international crude prices are rising. This is precisely why the government appears to have resisted a full pass-through of global prices for as long as possible. Had international costs been transferred directly to consumers, the increase could reportedly have been several times higher. In that context, the Rs 3 rise is less an aggressive burden and more a reluctant compromise.

Still, public discomfort cannot be dismissed merely through macroeconomic explanations. India today faces a deep contradiction. On one hand, it aspires to become a global economic powerhouse with expanding highways, aviation networks, and manufacturing ambitions. On the other hand, it remains acutely vulnerable to imported energy shocks. The current episode exposes the strategic fragility that accompanies excessive dependence on foreign oil. It also demonstrates why energy security can no longer be viewed only as an economic issue; it is now inseparable from national security and geopolitical stability.

The government's broader appeal for voluntary conservation — reducing unnecessary fuel consumption, limiting non-essential foreign travel, and discouraging excessive gold purchases — reflects this reality. Gold imports alone reportedly stand near \$72 billion annually, while outbound tourism drains another significant amount of foreign exchange. Combined with the crude oil bill, these create immense pressure on India's current account balance and currency stability. Authorities seem to believe that voluntary behavioural restraint is politically and socially preferable to coercive measures such as rationing, emergency restrictions, or drastic taxation.

There is also a notable political dimension to the current strategy. Previous governments facing external oil shocks often witnessed spiralling inflation, widening fiscal deficits, and currency instability. This time, policymakers are keen to highlight that key macroeconomic indicators remain relatively stable. India's current account deficit remains far below crisis-era levels seen a decade ago, and inflation, though elevated, has not yet spun out of control. The effort appears aimed at preserving both economic stability and public confidence simultaneously.

Yet the long-term lesson from this episode extends beyond temporary fuel pricing. India urgently needs to accelerate structural reforms that reduce exposure to global oil volatility altogether. Investments in renewable energy, electric mobility, public transport infrastructure, ethanol blending, green hydrogen, and domestic energy alternatives can no longer be treated merely as environmental goals. They are economic imperatives. Every geopolitical conflict in oil-producing regions reminds India how vulnerable its growth story remains to events beyond its borders.

At the same time, policymakers must remain sensitive to the cascading impact of fuel inflation on ordinary citizens. Even modest increases disproportionately affect lower-income households because transport costs influence the price of nearly every essential commodity. Governments cannot simply rely on appeals for patriotism and sacrifice indefinitely. Public trust depends on transparency, equitable burden-sharing, and visible efforts to protect vulnerable sections.

The present fuel hike, therefore, should not be viewed in isolation. It is part of a much larger global disruption in which India has attempted to cushion consumers longer than many nations could afford to. Whether one agrees with the eventual decision or not, the episode underlines a difficult truth: in an interconnected world vulnerable to wars, shipping disruptions, and commodity shocks, economic resilience requires both state intervention and public cooperation.

The challenge now is ensuring that temporary crisis management evolves into long-term energy independence. Otherwise, every geopolitical tremor abroad will continue to dictate the price Indians pay at home.

ILLNESS TO
WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON,
ADVISORY
COUNCIL, ILLNESS
TO WELLNESS
FOUNDATION

For India, the challenge is urgent but manageable. We have an estimated 220 million people living with hypertension, but only around 12 per cent have their blood pressure under control

India's Fight Against Hypertension

Hypertension control must move from personal worry to public responsibility through screening, awareness, treatment and healthier everyday living

World Hypertension Day, observed annually on 17 May, carries a particularly meaningful message in 2026 with the theme "Controlling Hypertension Together". It reminds us that hypertension is not merely a personal medical condition to be managed quietly at home, but a public health challenge that demands shared responsibility across families, communities, workplaces, healthcare providers and institutions. It places early detection, regular blood pressure screening and sustained healthy living at the centre of the campaign.

For many years, hypertension has been described as a silent killer because it often advances without obvious symptoms. Yet silence should not be mistaken for the absence of danger. Uncontrolled high blood pressure quietly damages blood vessels and vital organs, increasing the risk of heart attacks, strokes, kidney disease and other serious complications. Globally, an estimated 1.4 billion adults live with hypertension, making it one of the most widespread and consequential health challenges of our time.

For India, the challenge is urgent but manageable. The country has an estimated 220 million people living with hypertension, but only around 12 per cent have their blood pressure under control. This gap between diagnosis, treatment and control is where the real public health battle lies. It is not enough for people to know that the condition exists. They must know their own numbers, understand what those numbers mean, receive timely advice and treatment when required, and continue care even when they feel well.

For us at the Illness to Wellness Foundation, World Hypertension Day 2026 is an opportunity to move the conversation beyond fear and statistics. The purpose of awareness is not to alarm people, but to inform and empower them. A blood pressure reading is a simple act, often taking less than a minute, but it can become the first



For many years, hypertension has been described as a silent killer because it often advances without obvious symptoms

step towards preventing years of illness. When citizens begin to treat regular BP screening as a normal part of responsible living, preventive healthcare becomes part of daily culture rather than an emergency response.

India has already begun to build this preventive health architecture at scale. Through Ayushman Arogya Mandirs and national programmes for the prevention and control of non-communicable diseases, screening for hypertension and diabetes has expanded significantly. Recent government updates have reported that over 1.8 lakh Ayushman Arogya Mandirs have been operationalised across the country and 41.5 crore people were screened for hypertension through a nationwide screening drive. These figures are not merely administrative achievements but represent a major step towards taking preventive healthcare closer to people.

This is where India's public health innovation must be understood in its true sense. Technology is not limited to expensive machines or modern hospitals. In public health, innovation often lies in managing scale, access, simplicity and continuity. A blood pressure monitor in a health and wellness centre, a trained community health worker, a digital patient record, a reminder for follow-up, a teleconsultation for some-

one far from a specialist, and assured access to medicines can together become more powerful than technology that remains confined to elite institutions.

Digital tools are also changing the way hypertension is tracked and managed. Platforms used under hypertension control initiatives can help healthcare workers record blood pressure readings, medicines and follow-up visits, while giving health-system managers a clearer picture of control rates across facilities and regions. Affordable wearable devices with continuous monitoring, smartwatches that detect abnormal cardiovascular patterns, predictive algorithms integrated into electronic health records, and AI-guided treatment support can strengthen early detection and timely intervention when used responsibly. However, technology can achieve its full value only when people are aware, informed and willing to act on timely advice. Artificial intelligence can further support this effort by easing administrative burden, strengthening outreach, identifying risk patterns and helping frontline teams focus more closely on patient care. At a time when many people view AI through the anxiety of disruption, it must also be understood as a tool that can improve efficiency, save time and reduce repetitive

pressure. Time saved through better systems should not merely create more work, but should also allow space for recreation, rest, family and reflection, all of which are essential to long-term wellbeing.

Lifestyle remains central to this effort. Regular physical activity, maintaining a healthy weight, reducing salt intake, limiting alcohol, managing stress and taking prescribed medicines consistently are all essential. India's civilisational wisdom has long recognised that balance in daily life is itself a form of treatment. Traditional food habits based on fresh, seasonal diets, regular physical activity, and practices such as yoga, pranayama and meditation helped sustain both physical and mental equilibrium. In the Bhagavad Gita, Shri Krishna reminds us that health and harmony belong to those who are balanced in food, rest, activity and conduct. This recognition that excess, stress and imbalance disturb both mind and body reflects an understanding that is remarkably relevant to modern cardiovascular health. In a modern age marked by stress, long working hours and irregular habits, this inheritance offers a valuable lesson. Prevention becomes stronger when healthy choices are made visible, affordable, socially accepted and woven into the way we live.

There is also much to learn from international experience. Across countries that have improved hypertension control, the lesson is clear. Success does not come from awareness alone. It comes from standardised treatment protocols, reliable medicine supply, trained primary care teams, accurate blood pressure measurement, community follow-up and regular review of health data. The best systems are those that make the right action simple, accessible and repeatable.

India's strength lies in scale and affordability. Through digital public-health infrastructure, mobile connectivity, AI-enabled systems and community-health networks, technology is being adapted for mass population management rather than only individualised precision care. This makes India distinct from many developed nations. Furthermore, a deeper civilisational understanding of balanced living, where work, rest, food discipline, physical movement, reflection and family life are seen as part of a healthier regime. The next step is to combine this inherited wisdom with modern systems of screening, counselling, treatment, digital tracking and community-level support. If this integration is strengthened, millions of people can be protected from preventable complications.

Hypertension control is preventive healthcare in its clearest form. What can be detected through a simple measurement should not be allowed to become a life-altering crisis. I believe this occasion must become a call for every household, workplace, school, institution and community to treat blood pressure screening as a basic act of responsibility. Let us not wait for illness to announce itself through a stroke, heart attack or kidney complication. Let us act early, support one another and make hypertension control an everyday commitment to a healthier India, where wellness is not left to chance but built through awareness, discipline and timely action.

Views expressed are personal

AT
VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL
THE WRITER
IS AN AUTHOR
AND MEDIA
ENTREPRENEUR

Can India celebrate its protein revolution while millions still lack access to basic nutrition?

As Gen Alpha will say, we are "obsessed" — obsessed with getting protein into everything. Soon, maybe protein-packed salt and water will come in next! Jokes apart, the single-minded focus to induct protein into our daily diets has fast moved from a nutritional fad to an all-pervasive marketing trend. The truth? With a purported 80 per cent of Indians being protein-deficient, of course, we need adequate protein, which is about 0.83 gm of protein per kilogram of body weight consumed diligently every day. Protein is finally shedding its garb of being suitable only for gym rats, athletes, and bodybuilders, and rolling right into kitchen counters. Adding protein is that secret sauce preventing chronic lifestyle diseases and ensuring a healthier, stronger old age.

This new infatuation with protein has assumed virality. Every influencer worth their dumbbells is prescribing it, shop shelves are teeming with a gazillion brands, animal protein, whey, plant — here's what ideal for women, here's what's good for men, here's what's good for both their guts — we are spoilt and confused with choice. Everyone is jumping onto the bandwagon — legacy brands, scrappy startups, nutraceutical companies — there's something for everyone because the Indian protein market is booming. As per the IMARC Group, it touched USD 912.9 million last year and is slated to grow to USD 1,578.1 million by 2034. While the larger protein market is at USD 1.62 billion in 2026, the plant-based protein segment is the golden goose that's expected to return consistent dividends, as per Mordor Intelligence. Plant-based supplements are cleaner, lighter, and more gut-friendly, making it a safer choice for health-conscious consumers who want to give a wide berth to artificial or synthetic additives. Along with the



India's booming protein economy reflects rising health awareness, but also exposes deep inequalities in nutrition and food access

benefits of protein supplements there are also now warnings of fake powders laden with toxins and heavy metals doing the rounds.

I don't know if it happens to you but it sure happens to me — every time I travel overseas, my digestion miraculously improves. However, once back, almost anything can make me bloated or feel uncomfortable. We may suspect the sustained spraying of chemicals on our crops or long-term consumption of food with additives that may have messed up our gut microbiome. And it's not just me. Almost everyone today complains of food allergies and intolerances. The market is now flooded with gut-friendly and gut-fixing products, and that's no surprise. A healthy gut aids in digestion and improves numerous health markers including weight. Overall, this epiphany towards a clean, protein-rich diet is a positive trend. Traditionally, most Indian households have been carbs-heavy, meaning, we consume more carbohydrates through

daily consumption of rice and wheat. Flipping that to increase the amount of protein whether through meat, seafood, eggs, or grains, pulses, and dairy was absolutely essential to fighting obesity, diabetes, and so on.

As much as I laud this protein age (disclaimer: I'm on it too!), I can't help but balk at the dichotomy of our existence. It feels surreal that while we are promoting protein-rich milk, wheat, and all manners of powders, a major chunk of our nation's children are reportedly malnourished. As we reach for that scoop of protein shake and stir it into the beverage of our choice, I wonder, how many of us spare a thought for the underserved who have decreasing access to milk and eggs, forget meat and fish, because have you seen the pinching prices? As we become protein fiends and argue the pros and cons of downing raw eggs because our trainer said so, I want you to remember that a majority of the Indian population is not even getting its basic nutrition.

67 per cent of Indian children and over half the female population are anaemic. The United Nations' 2025 State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) report says that even though India has progressed, there are still over 172 million people who were undernourished in 2024. Chronic undernutrition and generational poverty has also meant that 67.1 per cent of Indian children are stunted. Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, and Jharkhand note high rates of malnutrition while a recent study published in the 'Journal of Economic Behaviour & Organisation' suggests that scheduled caste kids in north India are healthier than their southern counterparts. Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, and Odisha have made brave attempts to stem the tide of malnutrition that is over-running almost the entire country. Recently, Gujarat was arguing over how much their percentage of malnourished children is — the discussion shouldn't be about how much but rather why there are any at all? Government programmes such as the POSHAN Abhiyaan, ICDS (Integrated Child Development Services), and the Mid-day Meal Programme must be effectively strengthened to enable the protein-rich diets for children. The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) is currently running a four-year-long trial in six states (Maharashtra, Odisha, Meghalaya, Karnataka, Rajasthan, and Madhya Pradesh) to fight child malnutrition in the first three years of life.

Therefore, as we chase protein and muscle growth in our daily lives, it's pertinent to demand better health for the general populace too, where they can both afford and access nutritious, high-protein foods at affordable prices. Why should protein be the right of the rich alone?

Views expressed are personal

Philippine senator wanted by ICC flees from Senate

MANILA: A Philippine senator wanted by the International Criminal Court for an alleged crime against humanity has fled from the Senate, where he sought refuge to evade arrest, officials said Friday.

Sen Ronald dela Rosa's exit from the heavily guarded Senate came after volleys of gunshots were fired Wednesday night by the building's security personnel during an argument with gov-

ernment agents positioned in an adjacent building, sparking chaos that apparently helped the senator to slip out.

President Ferdinand Marcos Jr made a late-night TV statement to ask the public to remain calm.

A police investigation was underway, including into suspicions that the incident was instigated to provide dela Rosa a cover to escape.

"There is no obstruction of justice," Senate President Alan Cayetano said of dela Rosa's escape while in the Senate's protective custody.

He told a news briefing that he did not see any ICC warrant of arrest against dela Rosa and the senator was free to leave the premises. AGENCIES

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement System
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:

Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
08265085A	Commissioning of Universal Fail Safe Block Interface	42 Nos/Pair	08.06.26
12260031	Earthing Cable Complete for Wheel Set Earthing	11915 Nos	08.06.26
09262056	Bolster Bottom Gusset	2312 Nos	08.06.26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No. 12/ 2026-2027 **Dated: 15.05.2026**

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 1634/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE No. CSP-KSF_03_2026-27 **Date 14.05.2026**
On behalf of the President of India, Chief Engineer/TSP, Northern Railway, Headquarters office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001 invites the following tender through E-Procurement system:

S. Tender N.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Cost of tender document	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Estimated Tender value (in Rs.)	Date & Time of opening of tender	Period of completion
1	CSP-KSF_03_2026-27	Repair of different type of electrical & mechanical equipments/machines including supply of spare parts for a period of Two years at Concrete Sleeper Plant, Northern Railway, Khalispur-Varanasi (UP).	NIL	87,500/-	43,73,550/-	09.06.2026 at 15:00	24 months
2	CSP-KSF_04_2026-27	Provision of Comprehensive Maintenance (CMC) for a period of Two years for 'Akona' make Concrete Batching Plant (01 No.), Model AP-30 installed and commissioned in Old shed of Concrete Sleeper Plant, Northern Railway, Khalispur-Varanasi (UP)	NIL	17,500/-	8,74,976.40	15.06.2026 at 15:00	24 months
3	CSP-KSF_05_2026-27	Sawing & supplying of soft wood scantling of Mango or Eucalyptus or other locally available soft wood (size 50 mm X 50 mm, minimum 01 meter long) for a period of Two years to Concrete sleeper plant, N.Rly. of Concrete Sleeper Plant, Northern Railway, Khalispur-Varanasi (UP)	NIL	18,200/-	9,10,700/-	23.06.2026 at 15:00	24 months
4	CSP-KSF_06_2026-27	Fabrication, supply & Repair of Moulds and Modified Stress Benches for production of Special Type wider base sleepers & T/o Sleepers and Loading, leading & unloading of Railway material for a period of Two years	NIL	64,100/-	32,03,674.80	29.06.2026 at 15:00	24 months
5	TSD-G2B-01-20-26-27	Random testing of track fittings at Northern Railway, Track Supply Depot, Ghaziabad.	NIL	20,000/-	9,98,114.80	10.06.2026 at 15:00	24 months

Note:- The complete information of above E-Procurement tender is available on website "www.ireps.gov.in" 1620/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

कार्यालय कार्यपालन अभियंता, ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा, संभाग जगदलपुर
ई-प्रोक्चरमेंट निविदा सूचना क्र.-01 / 2025-26 (प्रथम निविदा आमंत्रण)
क्रमांक / 1303 / एस.ए.सी. / ग्रा.यां.सेवा / 2025-26 जगदलपुर, दिनांक 08.05.2026

छत्तीसगढ़ के राज्यपाल के और से एकीकृत पंजीयन प्रणाली के अंतर्गत लोक निर्माण विभाग में सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निम्न निर्माण कार्य हेतु निविदा ऑनलाइन (Online) दिनांक 22.05/2026 तक आमंत्रित की जाती है :-

क्र०	कार्य का विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रुपये लाख में)	मैनुअल दस्तावेज कार्यालय में पहुँचने की अंतिम तिथि
1	शासकीय दृष्टि एवं श्रवण बाधिताथ उ.मा.वि. आड़वाल परिसर में अतिरिक्त कक्षाएं एक्विटिटी कक्षा निर्माण विकास खण्ड जगदलपुर	170.76	25.05.2026

2. उक्त निर्माण कार्यों की निविदा सामान्य शर्तें, धरोहर राशि, विस्तृत निविदा विज्ञप्ति, निविदा दस्तावेज व अन्य जानकारी, कार्यालयीन अवधि में कार्यालय से प्राप्त की जा सकती है। साथ ही यह जानकारी विभागीय वेबसाइट <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> में दिनांक 11.5.26 'से डाउनलोड की जा सकती है।

कार्यपालन अभियंता
ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा
संभाग जगदलपुर
G 262700737/ 7

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.
Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE (As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon. The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Ankit Gupta/ Pooja Shahaj DEL-HL-000628 & DEL-NHL-000595/ Delhi	Property: Upper Ground Floor Without Roof/ Terrace Rights, Towards Back Side, Property Bearing No. 69 and 70-b, Block-D, Out of Kharsa No. 21/24, Situated In The Area Of Village Matiala, Colony Known As Nanhey Park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi West Delhi - 110059	25-Oct-2025/ Rs. 17,98,591/- Rupees Seventeen Lakh Ninety Eight Thousand Five Hundred Ninety One Only & Rs. 87,734/- Rupees Eighty Seven Thousand Seven Hundred Thirty Four Only	May 12, 2026

Date: May 16, 2026, **Place:** New Delhi

Sd/- Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

POSSESSION NOTICE
GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED
Registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, 208 & 208 A, 2nd Floor, ABW Tower, Sector 25, Gurugram- 122002

Possession Notice (For Immovable Property)
(Rule 8(1) of The Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)
Loan/Facility Account No.- GFL3101LP0046425- Loan Against Property- Loan granted to (1) M/s Sangeeta Metal Industries, (2) M/s Mohit Metal Industries, (3) Kamal Chauhan, (4) Mohit Chauhan and (5) Sangeeta Devi.

Whereas, the authorized officer of the Godrej Finance Limited, a Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 having registration as a housing company from the Reserve Bank of India & having registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra & One of the office at Godrej Capital, 208 & 208 A, 2nd Floor, ABW Tower, Sector 25, Gurugram, 122002 under The Securitization And Reconstruction Of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand Notice Dated **09.03.2026** calling upon Applicant/Borrower/Co-Aplicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgageors (1) M/s Sangeeta Metal Industries, (2) M/s Mohit Metal Industries, (3) Kamal Chauhan, (4) Mohit Chauhan and (5) Sangeeta Devi to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs. 1,60,46,767/- (INR One Crore Sixty Lakhs Forty-Six Thousand Seven Hundred and Sixty-Seven Only)** due as on **09.03.2026** with subsequent interest, penal interest, charges, costs etc. as per the agreement(s) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Aplicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgageors, having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Applicant/Borrower/ Co-Aplicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgageors in particular and the public in general that the undersigned authorized officer of company has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said act read with Rule 8 of the said rules in this 13th day of May 2026.

The Applicant / Borrower/ Co-Aplicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgageors attention is invited to provisions of Sub- Section (8) of Section 13 of the said act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets/.

The Applicant / Borrower/ Co-Aplicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgageors in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Godrej Finance Limited for the amount of **Rs. 1,60,46,767/- (INR One Crore Sixty Lakhs Forty-Six Thousand Seven Hundred and Sixty-Seven Only)** due as on **09.03.2026** and interest thereon from **10.03.2026**.

Description of Secured Assets/
All That Piece & Parcel of Property No. 30/28-A, Part of Plot No. 28-a, Area Measuring 71.0685 Sq. Mtrs I.e, 85 Sq. Yds., Out of Kharsa No. 819 Min, Situated At Village Chandrawali Alias Shahdara, In The Abadi of Block No. 30, Gali No. 09, Vishwas Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032 India, Boundaries Are Mentioned Below:- East: Na, West: Na, North: Na, South: Na
Date: 16.05.2026
Place: Delhi

Authorized Officer,
Godrej Finance Limited

THE WARRING SIDES AGREED TO A CEASEFIRE BROKERED BY PAKISTAN

Ceasefire with Iran a 'favour' to Pakistan: US Prez Trump

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump on Friday said he agreed to a ceasefire with Iran as a "favour" to Pakistan and ruled out any further bombing of the Persian Gulf nation, with which it has been at odds for several decades.

The US and Israel's war on Iran started on February 28, and attacks have been paused since April 8, when the warring sides agreed to a ceasefire brokered by Pakistan.

"We did the ceasefire as a request from another nation. I would have really benefited from it, but we did it as a favour to Pakistan. They are terrific people, the Field Marshal and the Prime Minister," Trump told reporters on Air Force One while returning from China to the US. Trump reiterated his resolve not to allow Iran to acquire nuclear weapons and to make them give up the enriched uranium Tehran has accumulated over the years. He said the Iranian nego-



US President Donald Trump

tiators were claiming that their nuclear facilities were damaged in the American air strikes and that they were not in a position to retrieve the nuclear fuel.

"They came up with a terrible secret. They said that they

can't remove it because they don't have the technology to remove it. They don't have the time and the practice," Trump said in response to questions on Iran. Trump said Chinese President Xi Jinping was also

in favour of opening up the Strait of Hormuz, which is a key trade route for 20 per cent of the global oil supplies.

US Vice President J D Vance-led a team of negotiators for the first-ever direct face-to-

Highlights

- » The US and Israel's war on Iran started on February 28
- » Trump reiterated his resolve not to allow Iran to acquire nuclear weapons
- » Trump said Chinese President Xi Jinping was also in favour of opening up the Strait of Hormuz

face talks with Iranian leaders in Islamabad on April 11-12, which got the warring nations into prolonged negotiations to end the decades-long hostilities.

The US has been insisting that Iran give a clear commitment to end its uranium enrichment programme in exchange for the lifting of sanctions and the release of billions in frozen Iranian funds. AGENCIES

Hinduja family tops UK's rich list under next-gen brothers

LONDON: The Hinduja family retained their top spot as the UK's richest family in the 2026 'Sunday Times Rich List', released on Friday, under a new generation of brothers following the death of Gopichand Hinduja last year.

"Sanjay and Dheeraj Hinduja and family" emerged as the UK's richest for the fifth successive year with an estimated 38 billion pounds, up from last year despite global headwinds. The Hinduja Group operates in 38 countries with investments across several sectors, including mobility, digital technology, banking and financial services, media,

project development, lubricants and specialty chemicals, energy, real estate, trading, and healthcare.

"The death of their father, Gopi Hinduja, at the age of 85 last November has handed his place at the top of the 'Sunday Times Rich List' to his London-based sons, Sanjay and Dheeraj," the newspaper notes.

"Sanjay, 62 this month, chairs Gulf Oil International while Dheeraj, 54, oversees the automotive giant Ashok Leyland. The latter has had a strong year, with the share price soaring by almost 40 per cent as more Indian motorists transition to electric vehicles.

"Indusind, the Mumbai-based banking and financial services group, has also had a decent 12 months. The shares here are up 14 per cent since last year," it states.

Besides the Hinduja family, the top 10 of the annual tally of the UK's richest sees another set of Indian-origin brothers, David and Simon Reuben, hold onto their wealth at second place with an estimated 27.97 billion pounds. "The India-born brothers are close to completing two vast renovations of historic London buildings, Admiralty Arch and Cambridge House, which are being transformed into luxurious hotels," the newspaper reveals.

While textiles entrepreneur Prakash Lohia has climbed a few spots to 28th with around 6.44 billion pounds, Vedanta Resources' industrialist Anil Agarwal has dropped to 43rd from last year's 25th with an estimated 3.85 billion pounds. AGENCIES

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
Central Bank of India
1911 से आपके लिए "सेन्ट्रल" "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911

Regional Office Delhi (South)
3rd Floor, Sorabji Bhawan, 4/54, D.B. Gupta Road, Karolbagh, New Delhi-110005

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1)] SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India (Secured creditors), **will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on date 10.06.2026** for recovery of dues to the Central Bank of India from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer/ Branch Head	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (in Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	In Rupees Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Anand Parbat New Delhi	Mr. Mukesh Rathore MOBILE: 9211521403	Mr. Pramod Gupta & Mrs. Chander Wati	Property Bearing No.RZ-6K/11/563 (Old No.RZ-6K/11) Out of Kharsa No.650, Entire Third Floor with Terrace Rights, Indira Park, Palam Colony, Nasirpur, New Delhi-110045. Area Measuring 75 Sq.Yds. Owner - Mr. Pramod Gupta	Rs.46,86,662.00 on 05.07.2022 + interest thereafter	06.04.2024 (Physical)	₹ 22,50,000.00 ₹ 2,25,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
2.	Gulmohar Park New Delhi	Ms. Archana Sharma MOBILE: 8448296394	Mr. Praveen Choudhary	RZ-750/23, Gali No 23, First Floor, Kharsa No 443/2, Tughlakabad Extension, New Delhi- 110019, carpet area 83.34 sq.mt, Owner - Mr Praveen Choudhary S/o Mr.AK Choudhary.	Rs.52,17,375.00 on 30.09.2020 + interest thereafter	14.09.2022 (Physical)	₹ 26,10,000.00 ₹ 2,61,000.00 ₹ 25,000.00
3.	Gulmohar Park New Delhi	Ms. Archana Sharma MOBILE: 8448296394	Vipin Kumar Gaur	First Floor Back Side Left Side Portion without Roof Rights, part of Property No RZ-902, Gali No- 23, measuring Area 45.84 Sq Mtr. out of Kharsa No 445, Situated at Tughlakabad Extension, New Delhi- 110019. Owner- Mr. Vipin Kumar Gaur S/o Mr. Murari Lal	Rs. 32,83,616.60 on 14.05.2025 + Interest thereafter	26.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 19,00,000.00 ₹ 1,90,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
4.	Janpath New Delhi	Mr. Ravi Kumar MOBILE: 9999917105	Mr. Mahindra Kumar, Mr.Lalit Kumar & Mrs. Seema	Plot No.E-649 (Old No.13), Out of Kharsa No.30/21, Mauza Saran, Dabua Colony, Faridabad, Measuring land area of 250 sq.yard. Owner - Mr. Lalit Kumar & Mr. Mahinder Kumar	Rs.30,23,089.00 on 29.10.2016 + interest thereafter	11.05.2017 (Physical)	₹ 36,34,000.00 ₹ 3,63,400.00 ₹ 35,000.00
5.	Janpath New Delhi	Mr. Ravi Kumar MOBILE: 9999917105	Mr. Rakesh Kumar & Mrs. Anita Devi	LIG Flat No. G-3 (Without Roof Rights), Ground Floor, Plot No. 222, Shalimar Garden Extension 1, Vill.- Pasonda, Ghaziabad, UP-201005. Owner - Mr. Rakesh Kumar & Mrs. Anita Devi	Rs.17,09,512.00 on 06.01.2017 + interest thereafter	07.12.2021 (Physical)	₹ 14,40,000.00 ₹ 1,44,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
6.	Karol Bagh New Delhi	Mr. Vinay Kumar MOBILE: 9999917126	Mr. Ranjeet Singh	DDA built up Residential Flat No.- 20 Fourth Floor (LIG) in Pocket- 3, Block- F-8, Sector- G-8, Narela, Delhi- 110040. Area- 472 Sq Ft, Owner- Mr. Ranjeet Singh S/o Mr. Amrik Singh	Rs. 14,20,145.46 on 30.05.2023 + interest thereafter	30.07.2025 (Physical)	₹ 11,92,000.00 ₹ 1,19,200.00 ₹ 10,000.00
7.	Lady Harding Medical College	Ms. Kumari Ritu MOBILE: 9319992541	Mr. Imran Khan and Mrs. Rehana	Free hold Residential Flat No.- F.F.- 1 First Floor (HIG) without Roof Rights on Plot No B-1/16, DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni, Ghaziabad, Area- 900 Sq Ft, Owner- Mr. Imran Khan S/o Mr. Mohammed Sharif and Mrs. Rehana W/o Mr. Imran Khan	Rs.10,01,634.29 on 14.06.2024 + interest thereafter	29.05.2025 (Physical)	₹ 15,30,000.00 ₹ 1,53,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
8.	Paharganj New Delhi	Mr. Rajiv Kumar MOBILE: 8847236384	Mr. Rakesh Kumar Sahu	Residential LIG Flat No SF- 3 (Second Floor), back Side with Roof Rights, situated at Plot No M.M.- 43, DLF Ankur Vihar, Village- Loni, District- Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201102, Super covered Area 400 Sq Feet, Owner- Mr. Rakesh Kumar Sahu S/o Mr. Laxman Prasad Sahu	Rs. 10,36,988.55 on 04.06.2024 + interest thereafter	19.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 9,15,000.00 ₹ 91,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00
9.	Patel Nagar New Delhi	Mr. Sandeep Singh MOBILE: 7250493569	Mr. Nitin Bhatia	Second Floor without Roof/ Terrace Rights of Built Up Property Bearing No. 191, Area measuring 50 Sq Yards, Part of Kharsa No. 171 situated in the Area of Village Bindarpur, Colony known as Nand Ram Park, Block-A, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi- 110059, Owner- Mr. Nitin Bhatia S/o Mr. Khem Chand Bhatia	Rs. 12,88,716.00 on 26.08.2024 + interest thereafter	30.05.2025 (Physical)	₹ 18,00,000.00 ₹ 1,80,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 10.06.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES
Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: 10.06.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.
Bidder will register on website: <https://BAANKNET.com> and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in **BAANKNET** EMD wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (<https://BAANKNET.com>). The auction will be conducted through common landing platform **BAANKNET.com Portal** (<https://BAANKNET.com>). E-auction will be held "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever is there is" basis. **Property shall be sold only above the Reserve Price. (All other charges/ dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).** For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbank.bank.in Secured Creditor or auction platform (<https://BAANKNET.com>). Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com

STATUTORY 15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002
Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgageors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 15.05.2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

Authorised Officer,
CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (South), New Delhi

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Electrical Department
(TRD Branch), Jabalpur e-TENDER
NOTICE: No. JBP/TRD/Tender/2026/02
Date: 13.05.2026

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRD) West Central Railway Jabalpur for and on behalf of the President of India invite sealed tenders from the reputed and experienced contractors having valid Electrical License issued in the name of firm by State Government as required under IE rules, 1956 with one of the partners or in his own name if sole proprietor. **Name of work :** TRD/OHE work for (A) Construction of LHS with Road cover shed, sump and pump in lieu of LC No.-4, 20, 52 and 62 & (B) ROB work at LC No.-16,231 and 234 of Jabalpur division., **Place of work :** Jabalpur Division., **Completion period :** 18 months, **Tender value (Cost of the work) :** Rs. 90,05,885.75/- (Rs. Ninety Lakh Five Thousand Eight Hundred Eighty Five and Seventy Five Paise only). **Earnest money :** Rs. 1,80,100.00/- **Date & Time for submission/ opening of tender :** 08.06.2026 15:00 Hrs./ 08.06.2026 15:30 Hrs., **Website address :** <https://www.ireps.gov.in> Tenderers are advised to regularly visit IREPS website "<http://www.ireps.gov.in>" to note any changes/corrigendum. Minimum eligibility criteria as per tender form shall be applicable for this tender.

(Sd)
Sr. DEE/TRD
West Central Railway Jabalpur

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

Trump, Xi conclude ‘very successful’ talks but no deals announced



POWERGRID

Transmitting Power, Transforming Lives








Extract of the Financial Results for the quarter and year ended 31st March, 2026
(₹ in Crore)

S. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter ended		Year ended		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1	Total Income for the period	11,954.70	12,482.39	46,995.88	46,325.32	11,970.69	12,590.80	47,684.43	47,459.38
2	Profit before Tax and Regulatory Deferral Account Balances	3,773.74	5,091.87	16,759.10	18,338.81	3,918.32	5,011.30	17,321.03	19,017.89
3	Net Profit after Tax for the period	4,552.80	4,336.17	15,921.00	15,353.57	4,546.33	4,142.87	15,927.95	15,521.44
4	Total Comprehensive Income comprising Net Profit after Tax and Other Comprehensive Income	4,547.17	4,254.45	16,066.78	15,114.24	4,597.65	4,065.38	16,193.78	15,285.16
5	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face value of share : ₹10/- each)	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60	9,300.60
6	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Balance sheet	90,628.01	82,915.05	90,628.01	82,915.05	91,193.43	83,362.21	91,193.43	83,362.21
7	Securities Premium Account	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28	5,509.28
8	Net worth	99,928.61	92,215.65	99,928.61	92,215.65	1,00,494.03	92,662.81	1,00,494.03	92,662.81
9	Total Borrowings	1,48,009.01	1,30,964.96	1,48,009.01	1,30,964.96	1,48,009.01	1,30,964.96	1,48,009.01	1,30,964.96
10	Debt Equity Ratio	1.48	1.42	1.48	1.42	1.47	1.41	1.47	1.41
11	Earnings per equity share including movement in Regulatory Deferral Account Balances (Face value of ₹10/- each): Basic and Diluted (in ₹) *	4.90	4.66	17.12	16.51	4.89	4.46	17.13	16.69
12	Earnings per equity share excluding movement in Regulatory Deferral Account Balances (Face value of ₹10/- each): Basic and Diluted (in ₹) *	9.00	4.61	20.15	16.21	8.94	4.40	20.11	16.39
13	Bonds Redemption Reserve	2,721.31	3,193.24	2,721.31	3,193.24	2,721.31	3,193.24	2,721.31	3,193.24
14	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	2.11	1.55	1.54	1.48	2.25	1.57	1.61	1.53
15	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	4.13	3.83	3.93	3.94	4.85	4.16	4.57	4.28

(*) Figures for the quarters have not been annualized

Notes:

1. The above is an extract of the Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 and 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The Complete Financial Results are available on the Investors section of our website <https://www.powergrid.in> and under Corporates Section of BSE Limited & National Stock Exchange of India Limited at <https://www.bseindia.com> and <https://www.nseindia.com> respectively. These can also be accessed by scanning Quick Response Code:

2. Previous periods figures have been rearranged/reclassified wherever considered necessary.

For and on behalf of **POWER GRID CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.**

Sd/-
G Ravisankar, Director (Finance)
DIN: 00816101



POWER GRID CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
Corporate Office: "Saudamini", Plot No. - 2, Sector - 29, Gurugram - 122 001(Haryana), Tel.: 0124-2571700-719
Registered Office: B-9, Qutab Institutional Area, Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi - 110016, Tel: 011-26560112, 26560121, CIN : L40101DL1989GOI038121

Follow us :



www.powergrid.in



TRADE DEFICIT WIDENED TO A THREE-MONTH HIGH OF \$28.38 BILLION

India’s exports rise at fastest pace in 5-months to \$43.56 bn in April

OUR CORRESPONDENT

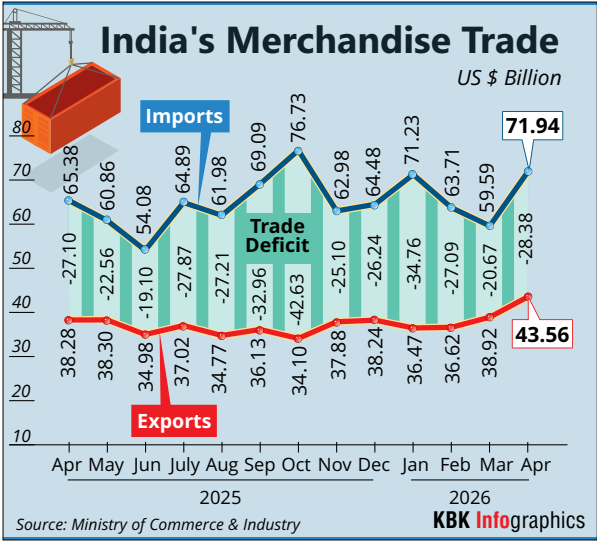
NEW DELHI: Exports rose by 13.78 per cent to \$43.56 billion in April, the highest monthly outbound shipments in more than four years, driven by petroleum products amid a surge in crude oil prices, but trade deficit widened to a three-month high of \$28.38 billion due to an uptick in imports.

Imports grew by 10 per cent year-on-year to a six-month high of \$71.94 billion in April, inflating the trade deficit. The gap between imports and exports, or trade deficit, was \$27.1 billion in April 2025 and \$20.67 billion in March 2026.

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said that despite global geopolitical tensions, the country’s exports are registering healthy growth. Exports grew at the fastest pace in five months in April. “The positive growth in value may also have some contribution from the price because prices of many things are going up so that may have some positive impact,” he told reporters here.

The key drivers of exports include electronic goods (40.31 per cent), meat and dairy (48 per cent), petroleum products (34.66 per cent), engineering items (8.76 per cent), and pharmaceuticals (7.12 per cent).

Electronic exports rose to \$5.17 billion, while shipments of



Imports grew by 10 per cent year-on-year to a six-month high of \$71.94 billion in April, inflating the trade deficit

petroleum products were worth \$9.6 billion in April. Brent crude oil prices have risen by \$11.47, or nearly 12 per cent, to \$107.51 per barrel on May 15 from \$96.04 per barrel on March 16, 2026. At its peak, Brent crude had surged by \$30.37, or about 32 per cent, to \$126.41 per barrel on April 30 compared with the March 16 level.

Diversification of exports in new markets has also helped shipments record the highest

growth rate in five months in April. Healthy growth has been registered in destinations such as Singapore, Tanzania, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Hong Kong, Malaysia, Australia, and Vietnam.

However, the country’s merchandise exports to the West Asian region declined 28 per cent to \$4.16 billion last month against \$5.78 billion in April 2025. Imports from the region also declined by 31.64 per cent

Key Points

» Trade deficit or gap between imports and exports was \$27.1 bn in April 2025 & \$20.67 bn in March 2026

» However, the country’s merchandise exports to the West Asian region declined 28% to \$4.16 bn in April against \$5.78 bn in April 2025

» Imports from the region also declined by 31.64% to \$10.47 bn in April from \$15.32 bn in the year-ago period

» Gold & silver imports rose 81.69% to \$5.62 bn & 157.16% to \$411 mn, respectively, during the month under review

to \$10.47 billion in April from \$15.32 billion in the year-ago period.

The ongoing US-Iran conflict has severely impacted the movement of ships carrying cargoes in international waters, particularly through the Strait of Hormuz.

As per the commerce ministry data, gold and silver imports rose 81.69 per cent to \$5.62 billion and 157.16 per cent to \$411 million, respectively, during the

month under review. Crude oil imports, however, dipped 10 per cent to \$18.7 billion.

The data also showed that services exports for April are estimated at \$37.24 billion, compared with \$32.85 billion in April 2025. The imports were \$16.66 billion, compared with \$16.91 billion in April 2025.

When asked about impact of depreciating rupee of exports, the secretary said “till now it has been showing positive trajectory and I think the early signs from May also look at me being in positive”.

The government is also suggesting industry to settle international for the last few years in the domestic currency. However, the movement is still at a very nascent stage, he added.

Agrawal also said that the ministry will work towards pushing the overall exports to \$1 trillion in 2026-27.

The Rs 25,060 crore export promotion mission and free trade agreements will help push the shipments this year.

“New operational agreements will create opportunities for our exporters, which they are already working around to see how best we can leverage it. We are looking forward to the operationalisation of some of these FTAs in the next few months,” he said. India has signed trade deals with the UK, Oman, New Zealand & the EU.

Rupee hits record low of 96.14 per \$, settles at fresh closing low of 95.81/\$

In domestic equity market, Sensex fell 160.73 points to 75,237.99, while Nifty declined 46.10 points to 23,643.50

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The Indian rupee crashed below the 96/\$mark on Friday before closing at an all-time low of 95.81 against the US dollar as elevated crude oil prices and inflation concerns added to the downside pressure on the rupee.

Rupee has registered over 6 per cent losses so far this year, and in the past six trading sessions, it has depreciated nearly 2 per cent as Iran war risk escalation pushed crude oil prices higher. The dollar index moved northwards after strong US retail sales and stable labour market data reduced expectations of aggressive Federal Reserve rate cuts.

Forex traders said global uncertainties, relatively high valuations, and the lack of A-led investment opportunities have weighed on capital flows.

Moreover, weak net FDI inflows are likely to exert pressure on the balance of payments, while rising crude oil prices stoke inflation worries.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.86, then slumped to a record low of 96.14 in intraday trade, registering a fall of 50 paise from its previous close.

The USD/INR pair finally settled at its lowest-ever closing level of 95.81 against the US dollar, registering a fall of 17 paise from its previous close, helped



Rupee has recorded over 6% losses so far this year, and in past six trading sessions, it has declined nearly 2% as Iran war pushed oil prices higher

by likely RBI intervention.

On Thursday, the rupee weakened to a fresh record low of 95.96 before closing with a marginal gain of 2 paise at 95.64 against the US dollar.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.15, higher by 0.34 per cent.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, was trading up 3.14 per cent at \$109.04 per barrel in futures trade.

On the domestic equity market front, Sensex fell 160.73 points to settle at 75,237.99, while Nifty declined 46.10 points to 23,643.50.

Highlights

» Weak net FDI inflows are likely to exert pressure on the balance of payments, while rising crude oil prices stoke inflation worries

» Dollar index, which gauges dollar’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.15, up by 0.34%

» FIs turned net buyers, purchasing equities worth Rs 187.46 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data

Foreign Institutional Investors (FII) turned net buyers, purchasing equities worth Rs 187.46 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.

“We expect the rupee to trade with a negative bias on elevated crude oil prices and inflation concerns. Strong dollar and FII outflows may also weigh on the rupee. However, any intervention by the RBI and hiking of import duty on gold and silver may support the rupee at lower levels. USD-INR spot price is expected to trade in a range of 95.60 to 96.20,” said Anuj Choudhary, Research analyst at Mirae Asset ShareKhan.

Forex stocks rise \$6.295 bn to \$696.988 bn

MUMBAI: India’s forex reserves jumped by \$6.295 billion to \$696.988 billion during the week ended May 8, the Reserve Bank said on Friday.

The overall reserves had dropped by \$7.794 billion to \$690.693 billion in the previous reporting week.

The forex kitty had expanded to an all-time high of \$728.494 billion during the week ended February 27 this year, before the onset of the West Asia crisis, which led to several weeks of drop, as the rupee came under pressure and the RBI had to intervene in the forex market through dollar sales.

For the week ended May 8, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased by \$562 million to \$552.387 billion, the central bank’s data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include the effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in the foreign exchange reserves.

Value of gold reserves jumped by \$5.637 billion to \$120.853 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The Special Drawing Rights were up by \$84 million to \$18.873 billion, the RBI said. India’s reserve position with the IMF was also up by \$12 million to \$4.875 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the RBI data.

India’s exports to China increase by 27% in April, imports up 20.85%

NEW DELHI: India’s exports to China increased by 27 per cent in April, while imports from the neighbouring country rose 20.85 per cent, according to the government data.

While exports increased to \$1.77 billion in April 2026 from \$1.39 billion in April 2025, imports rose to \$11.97 billion in April 2026 from \$9.90 billion in the year-ago month, the data showed.

The trade deficit stood at \$10.2 billion as against \$8.51 billion in April 2025.

China has overtaken the US to emerge as India’s largest trading partner in 2025-26, with bilateral trade reaching \$151.1 billion, while the country’s trade deficit with Beijing widened to \$112.16 billion during the period.

India’s exports to the US grew 1.14 per cent to \$8.47 billion during the month under review from \$8.38 billion in April 2025

The US was India’s largest trading partner for four consecutive years till 2024-25.

India’s exports to the US grew 1.14 per cent to \$8.47 billion during the month under review from \$8.38 billion in April 2025.

Imports from the US, however, dipped 4.67 per cent year-on-year to \$5.27 billion. Significant jump in the

country’s merchandise exports to Singapore, Tanzania, Hong Kong, Malaysia, Vietnam, Australia, Bangladesh have helped to clock 5-month high growth of 13.48 pc in April.

Exports to Singapore jumped 179.18 per cent to \$3.19 billion, to Tanzania by 157.63 per cent to \$1.29 billion, and Sri Lanka by 214.65 per cent to \$1.02 billion in April.

However, exports to the Netherlands and France registered negative growth last fiscal year.

Imports from Oman surged 246.42 per cent to \$1.48 billion, 315.56 per cent from Peru to \$1.26 billion. India’s inbound shipments from Taiwan, Brazil, and Nigeria rose by over 100 per cent.

NEW DELHI: India’s unemployment rate (UR) among persons aged 15 years and above rose to a six-month high of 5.2 per cent in April 2026, according to the latest Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation on Friday.

The unemployment rate remained broadly stable compared with 5.1 per cent recorded in March 2026 and April 2025, but matched the previous high seen in October 2025, according to the 13th monthly PLFS bulletin for April 2026.

Urban unemployment eased marginally to 6.6 per cent in April from 6.8 per cent in March, while rural unemployment increased to 4.6 per cent from 4.3 per cent during

Urban unemployment eased to 6.6% in April from 6.8% in March, while rural unemployment rose to 4.6% from 4.3% during same period

the same period. On a year-on-year basis, unemployment levels in both rural and urban areas remained largely unchanged.

Among males aged 15 years and above, the unemployment rate stood at 5.1 per cent in April 2026, compared with 5 per cent in March and 5.2 per cent in April 2025.

Rural male unemployment

increased from 4.4 per cent in March to 4.7 per cent in April, while urban male unemployment declined from 6.1 per cent to 5.9 per cent.

Female unemployment rate was recorded at 5.4 per cent in April 2026 against 5.3 per cent in March and 5 per cent in April 2025. Rural female unemployment fell to 4.1 per cent from 4.4 per cent over the month, while urban female unemployment declined to 8.5 per cent from 9 per cent. The report noted that urban female unemployment was at its lowest level since April 2025.

The Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) for persons aged 15 years and above declined to 55 per cent in April 2026 from 55.4 per cent in March 2026 and 55.6 per cent in

April 2025. Rural LFPR stood at 57.5 per cent, while urban LFPR was recorded at 50.1 per cent.

Female LFPR also moderated to 33.9 per cent in April from 34.4 per cent in March. Rural female LFPR remained unchanged year-on-year, while urban female LFPR declined by 0.7 percentage points.

The Worker Population Ratio (WPR) at the all-India level stood at 52.2 per cent in April 2026, down from 52.6 per cent in March and 52.8 per cent a year earlier. Urban WPR remained unchanged at 46.8 per cent, while rural WPR declined to 54.9 per cent from 55.5 per cent in March.

The survey estimates were based on responses from 3,74,243 persons across the country.

India & UK working on British steel issue to operationalise trade pact: Commerce Secy

NEW DELHI: India and the UK are working on a “unique and creative solution” to address issues arising from Britain’s recent steel safeguard measure, which is delaying the operationalisation of the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA).

The two countries, on July 24, 2025, signed the pact, under which 99 per cent of Indian exports would enter the UK duty-free, while India will reduce tariffs on British products such as cars and whisky.

“We are very near to operationalising that. There are a few sticking points, as you



are aware, the UK has come ahead with a steel measure recently, which was not factored in while negotiating the India-UK deal.

“We are working together to find a unique, creative solution around the steel measure also so that we can officialise the

India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement at an early date,” Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal told reporters here.

From 1 July 2026, the UK will limit tariff-free steel imports, reducing overall quota volumes by 60 per cent compared to the steel safeguard measure. Any imports above these levels will then face a 50 per cent tariff.

The measure will apply to imports of steel products that can also be made in the UK.

Earlier, Britain had safeguard measures that also imposed import quotas. The new measures reduce that

quota.

India’s exports of iron and steel and their products to the UK stood at \$893.4 million in 2025-26, accounting for a significant share of the \$13.4 billion in total merchandise exports to the UK.

The CETA was vetted by both houses of the UK’s Parliament in March. In India, the Union Cabinet approves trade agreements.

Now, both sides must agree on a date for the Entry into Force (EIF) of the agreement. Both sides are looking to double the bilateral trade from the current \$56 billion by 2030.

‘Changing lifestyles driving rise in hypertension among youth’

‘Long working hours, poor sleep, sedentary lifestyles & stress were contributing to rising hypertension’

NEW DELHI: Union Minister of State (I/C) for Ayush and Minister of State for Health and Family Welfare Prataprao Jadhav has called for greater public awareness and community sensitisation on hypertension, warning that changing lifestyles are driving a sharp rise in cases even among the youth.

In a video message at the “Illness to Wellness Conference on Transforming Hypertension Care: Prevention to Wellness”, organised ahead of World Hypertension Day 2026, Jadhav described hypertension as a “silent killer” that often progresses without symptoms and can trigger heart attacks and strokes. “In today’s time, it is essential that we make our com-

munities more sensitive and aware, and strengthen awareness about hypertension,” he said. Jadhav said the government, under the National Programme for Prevention and Control of Non-Communicable Diseases (NPCDCS), is promoting population-based screening, early detection and treatment through Health and Wellness Centres nationwide.

The conference, organised by the Illness to Wellness Foundation, brought together policymakers, cardiologists and health experts to discuss preventive and wellness-driven approaches to hypertension care.

Rajesh Bhushan, Chairperson of the Governing Council of the foundation, said hyper-



L to R: Prof. Rakesh Yadav, Cardiologist & Head - Dept of Emergency Medicine, AIIMS, New Delhi; Anil Rajput, Chairperson, Advisory Council, Illness to Wellness Foundation; Rajesh Bhushan, Former Secretary, Ministry of Health, Govt & Chairperson, Governing Council, IWF; Dr. Ripen Gupta, Vice Chairman & Unit Head - Cardiology, Max Smart Super Speciality Hospital, Saket and Dr. Sanjeev Singh, Chairperson, FICCI Medical Education Task Force and Medical Director, AIIMSRC Faridabad & Chief Medical Superintendent, Amrita School of Medicine, Kochi

tension was as prevalent in rural India as in urban areas.

“Early detection is extremely important because without

CLOSER LOOK

» ‘Hypertension was as prevalent in rural India as in urban areas’

» ‘Early detection is extremely important because without early detection, treatment becomes difficult’

» Experts Ripen Gupta & Rakesh Yadav stressed the need for regular blood pressure monitoring, lifestyle changes, obesity control

early detection, early treatment becomes difficult,” he said, add-

ing that non-communicable diseases significantly impact GDP across countries.

Anil Rajput said long working hours, poor sleep, sedentary lifestyles and stress were contributing to rising hypertension and lifestyle disorders. Referring to concerns around Artificial Intelligence, he said, “AI should not only be viewed through the lens of automation or job displacement, but also as an opportunity to improve the quality of human life.”

Cardiology experts including Ripen Gupta and Rakesh Yadav stressed the need for regular blood pressure monitoring, lifestyle changes, obesity control and adherence to long-term treatment.

Air India receives new Boeing 787-9 aircraft

NEW DELHI: Air India has received another tailor-made Boeing 787-9 aircraft, which landed in the national capital on Friday.

The airline is expanding its fleet and this is the second tailor-made Boeing 787-9 aircraft taken by the carrier after privatisation in January 2022.

“The second made-for-Air India Boeing 787-9, bearing registration mark VT-AWB, just touched down in Delhi after a non-stop flight from Charleston, United States.

“This brand-new aircraft sporting Air India’s new livery is a part of our effort to upgrade our wide-body fleet and deliver a world-class



premium experience to our guests on long-haul routes,” the airline said in a post on X on Friday.

Air India has 33 Boeing 787s or Dreamliners in its fleet of over 190 planes.

Apart from the 26 legacy Boeing 787-8s, there are 7 Boeing 787-9s, including 6 from Vistara and the first tailor-made plane that was inducted in January this year.

Marshalling LSG to win

Marsh's powerful 90 powers LSG to 7-wicket win over CSK

LUCKNOW: Mitchell Marsh's 38-ball 90 was a stunning rhapsody of power, carrying an already-eliminated Lucknow Super Giants to a seven-wicket win over Chennai Super Kings in an IPL match here on Friday.

Once the Super Kings posted a healthy 187 for five, which was built around Kartik Sharma's prudent 71, the Super Giants' task was cut out on a slightly two-paced track.

But Marsh, who along with his Australia teammate Josh Inglis (36, 31b) added 135 runs for the opening wicket to make a mockery of the pitch and even more so of some listless bowling by CSK. Chennai stayed on 12 points from as many games, and now they need to win both their remaining matches and some other results to go their way to have a chance to enter the play-offs. There was some assistance to exploit on the deck, particularly if you dug the ball in, but the Chennai bowlers were more keen to discover from non-existent swing while pitching the ball up.

On other occasions, the attempted snorters turned out to be pathetic half-trackers, but Marsh was not complaining.

The 34-year-old gorged on the offerings in his inimitable style. Pacer Anshul Kam-



LSG's Mitchell MarshL scored a 38-ball 90 to set up the win

PTI

boj felt the brute strength of 'Bison' while getting pasted for four sixes in a row with a four to boot in the fifth over the chase. The over yielded 28 runs.

The LSG ended the Power Play with an impressive 86 without loss and Marsh continued to drive his side. Pacer

Spencer Johnson was his next target, hitting him for two fours and a six as the runs flowed in thick and fast.

Marsh reached his fifty off just 21 balls, and reaching a landmark only fuelled his desire to score even quicker.

But the smooth-sailing alli-

ance was broken when Inglis skied Mukesh Choudhary to Urvil. Marsh, who looked set for a second hundred of the season, departed in an unfortunate manner as Nicholas Pooran's straight drive crashed onto stumps at non-striker's end after taking a deflection from Choudhary's fingers.

The Super Giants seemed to be in a slight worry and also needed 24 runs off 24 balls, but Pooran (32, 17b) struck Kamboj for four sixes on the bounce, just like Marsh did earlier, as they reached home in 16.4 overs. Kamboj ended up with disastrous figures of 2.4-0-63-0. Earlier, Kartik (71, 42 balls) made a composed fifty after CSK's top-order stumbled against LSG bowlers' hard length strategy.

Kartik and Dewald Brevis (25) added 70 runs for the fourth wicket as CSK slipped out of a tight 52 for three after 7.2 overs.

Kartik has an obvious discomfort against deliveries that raise around his chin but he showed gumption to stay there and overcome the little chink.

On this night, the right-hander started off with freeing his arms against spinner Shahbaz Ahmed, smoking him for a six, and later for a maximum and two fours in a row. AGENCIES

PBKS are feeling the heat: Haddin

DHARAMSALA: Punjab Kings assistant coach Brad Haddin admitted that his side has struggled to cope with pressure after it suffered a fifth successive defeat to continue a stunning mid-season slump in the ongoing Indian Premier League.

PBKS' latest loss came against Mumbai Indians, who emerged winners by six wickets in a last-ball thriller in the hill town on Thursday night.

It was a far cry from the seven-match unbeaten streak that PBKS enjoyed earlier in the season. The latest setback has left PBKS with a must-win scenario in their remaining two games to stay in playoff contention. "We have just not been able to handle pressure in the last few defeats. We have not played our best cricket when we need to, which has been disappointing," Haddin said in the post-match presser. AGENCIES

KOLKATA: Back home after nearly a month on the road and with their campaign hanging by a thread, Kolkata Knight Riders will look to stay alive in the IPL when they face a rampaging Gujarat Titans side chasing a top-two finish, here on Saturday.

It has been another inconsistent and underwhelming season for KKR under veteran Ajinkya Rahane, whose appointment as captain itself had raised questions after the franchise finished a disappointing eighth under him last year.

KKR had to wait till their seventh match (halfway stage) of the season to register their first win and have looked far from a settled side throughout the campaign, with questionable team selections and batting-order hurting their rhythm.

Their brief revival, which brought four consecutive wins starting with the victory over Rajasthan Royals in their last home match on April 19, ended with a defeat to Royal Challengers Bengaluru after sloppy fielding and a batting masterclass by Virat Kohli.

KKR now have three matches remaining and can reach a maximum of 15 points if they win all of them, but even that may not guarantee a play-



KKR's players jog during a training session

PTI

KKR have 3 matches remaining and can reach a maximum of 15 points if they win all

off berth as qualification would then depend on other results.

Another defeat, however, would virtually end their campaign and could also intensify scrutiny on Rahane's future with the franchise.

Their four-match winning run was built largely around the return to form of spin twins Sunil Narine and Varun Chakravarthy, along with consistent contributions from vice-captain Rinku Singh.

But Chakravarthy's absence

against RCB because of a fractured left leg proved costly.

Varun comeback

There is some relief for KKR though, with head coach Abhishek Nayar hinting at the spinner's return.

"We're always excited to go back (home). We have our fans there, and we're looking to make sure when Varun comes back in the next game, we get our strong bowling side back together and use home conditions to our advantage," Nayar had said after the six-wicket defeat to RCB. KKR's batting has lacked consistency all season and even former captain Sourav Ganguly publicly questioned the team management's handling of Rinku, saying at an event that the left-hander bats "too low". AGENCIES

SAYS HE'S PAST THAT PHASE Kohli draws the line on proving himself



RCB's Virat Kohli recently slammed another IPL ton

PTI

NEW DELHI: Virat Kohli still loves the game enough to be focussed on playing next year's World Cup but the star India batter also makes it clear that if his worth is constantly called into question in a certain "environment", he would accept that the "place is not meant" for him.

Speaking on his IPL franchise Royal Challengers Bengaluru's podcast, the 37-year-old superstar said he detests constant change of positions as far as the judgement on his value is concerned.

"I am always ready because that's my daily life. You know, I work out, we eat well at home. It is because I like living that way. It is not only to play cricket. So that is where I am. I mean, this 27 (2027 World Cup) chat and all that...I've been asked so many times, 'do you want to play 27?'" he said.

"I know the answer. Like, why would I leave my home, you know, get my stuff over and be like, I don't know what I want. Of course, if I'm playing, I want to play cricket. I want to carry on. Playing a World Cup for India is amazing. But as I said, the value has to be two sides," he asserted.

"My perspective is very clear. If I can add value to the

“If I have to prove my worth and value, that place is not meant to be for me

Virat Kohli

environment that I am part of, and the environment feels that I can add value, I will be seen. If I am made to feel like I need to prove my worth and my value, I am not in that space," said Kohli, who is counted among the greats of the game.

Kohli only plays the ODI format now after quitting T20 Internationals in 2024 and Tests in 2025. With ODI schedule shrinking considerably in the past few years, Kohli's India appearances are now scarce.

The next series he is likely to feature in is the away three-match assignment against England from July 14 to July 19. Despite his desire to be a part of the team, India head coach Gautam Gambhir has been largely non-committal on what the future holds for both Kohli and another ODI great Rohit Sharma. AGENCIES

Marijne calls for consistency and discipline

NEW DELHI: Following an impressive outing against Argentina, Indian women's hockey team chief coach Sjoerd Marijne wants his players to maintain discipline to produce consistent performance in the upcoming tournaments.

The Indian team drew 2-2 against world no. 2 Argentina in a four-match series. After losing the first two games, India staged a strong comeback, winning the final two matches (including a shoot-out) to level the series. India will next tour Australia for a four-match series from May 21 to June 3 as part of its preparations for next month's Nation's Cup in New Zealand, a pathway to the elite Pro League.

"In the last two matches in Argentina tour we played really well, where we won and played a draw and that's where I saw the behaviour I always wanted to see. The main thing which I want to achieve in Australia tour and the Nations Cup is to continue the good habits, continuity in behaviour. If we get more consistency in our game, our level goes much higher and higher," he said. Marijne said all these tours and tournaments are crucial to India's preparations. AGENCIES

Sakshi, Lovlina, Jadumani punch CWG and Asian Games tickets

PATIALA: Olympics bronze medallist Lovlina Borgohain, giant-killer Sakshi Chaudhary, Jadumani Singh and Narender Berwal headlined the final day of selection trials here on Friday as the boxers sealed their spots for the Commonwealth Games and Asian Games amid fierce competition and weight-category reshuffles.

Joining them on the plane to Glasgow and Japan will be world championship bronze medallist Parveen Hooda (65kg), Sumit Kundu (70kg), Ankush (80kg) and Kapil Pokhariya (90kg), all of whom emerged triumphant in their respective finals.

Reigning national champion Aditya Pratap Singh (65kg), meanwhile, booked his place only for the Commonwealth Games scheduled to be held in Glasgow in July-August.

The Asian Games will be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan in September-October.

The trials were marked by weight-category switches as boxers tried to fit in to the limited weight classes.

In what was arguably the marquee clash of the day, two-time youth world champion Sakshi produced another clinical display to blank reigning 48kg world champion



After Zareen shocker, Sakshi Chaudhary beat Minakshi Hooda

BFI

Minakshi Hooda 5-0 and clinch the 51kg spot.

It was her second win over a world champion in as many days as Sakshi had defeated two-time world gold medallist Nikhat Zareen on Thursday.

The victory capped off a remarkable turnaround for Sakshi, who had failed to make the cut for the Asian Championships under the federation's now-scrapped assessment system. With Preeti Pawar already securing the 54kg quota through her Asian Championships gold medal, Sakshi moved down a category, a gamble that paid off handsomely.

Lovlina's towering presence in Indian women's boxing continued as she barely broke a sweat in the 75kg final, dismantling Sanamacha Chanu 5-0

Minakshi too had been forced to move up from 48kg as her original division does not feature in either of the multi-sport event. "My mindset was that I want to get the quota anyhow. I brought down my weight from 55kg so that was also a struggle for me. But the weight loss increased my will power. It was a do or die for me," Sakshi told said.

Lovlina's towering presence in Indian women's boxing continued as the former world champion barely broke a sweat in the 75kg final, dismantling Sanamacha Chanu 5-0.

The flamboyant Jadumani overcame a significant height disadvantage to outbox Nikhil in a commanding 5-0 victory in 55kg final. AGENCIES

Sindhu, Lakshya out of Thailand Open, Satwik-Chirag pair marches on



BANGKOK: Indian badminton ace PV Sindhu squandered a one-game advantage to go down fighting to top seed Akane Yamaguchi of Japan in the quarterfinals, but the ace men's doubles pair of Satwik-sairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty entered the semifinal of the Thailand Open here on Friday.

Sindhu lost 21-19, 18-21, 15-21 to world No.3 Yamaguchi in the women's singles quarterfinal match that lasted just over one hour in the USD 500,000 Super 500 tournament.

Despite the loss, world number 12 Sindhu leads the head-to-head record against Yamaguchi 15-13. In the Malaysia Open Super 1000

tournament in January, Sindhu had prevailed after Yamaguchi retired from their quarterfinal game due to an injury.

Lakshya Sen too lost his men's singles quarterfinal match to second seed

Kunlavut Vitidsarn of Thailand, going down 19-21, 16-21 in 53 minutes.

However, there was some positive news in the doubles event, as top seeds Satwiksairaj and Chirag advanced to the semifinals with a commanding 21-12, 21-13 victory over the sixth-seeded Japanese pair of Takumi Nomura and Yuichi Shimogami. The Indian duo will next face the third-seeded Malaysian pair, Goh Sze Fei and Nur Izzuddin. AGENCIES

Injury-hit Romelu Lukaku in Belgium's WC squad

BRUSSELS: Romelu Lukaku's efforts to recover from injuries seem to have paid off after the Napoli striker was included in Belgium's World Cup squad Friday.

Lukaku, midfield great Kevin de Bruyne and Real Madrid goalkeeper Thibaut Courtois are set to play their fourth World Cup campaigns.

Lukaku has 124 games for Belgium, de Bruyne 117 and Courtois 107, making them some of the most experienced players on any team at the World Cup. They all trail 37-year-old defensive midfielder Axel Witsel, also heading into a fourth tournament. He has played for Belgium 136 times. Lukaku hasn't played for Belgium in almost a year since scoring against Wales in World Cup qualifying in June. Injuries have limited the 33-year-old striker to just five Serie A games for Napoli this season.

He was selected for Belgium's most recent friendlies in March and April but withdrew from the squad over more fitness concerns. Courtois' last game for the national team was in October and he was left out of Belgium's most recent squad over injury issues, but he's been a key player for Real Madrid this season. AGENCIES



Deschamps reveals France's galaxy of stars for FIFA World Cup

PARIS: France coach Didier Deschamps assembled a squad with formidable attacking talent for the World Cup and rewarded goalkeeper Robin Riser with a call-up for the showpiece tournament on Thursday following his breakthrough season.

Risser, who plays for Lens, has been one of the revelations of the French league season and won the award for the best goalkeeper earlier this week. He played a big role in making Lens the second-best defense in Ligue 1 and was selected by Deschamps in a No. 3 role behind Mike Maignan and Brice Samba.

"I'm full of pride, it's something incredible," Riser told broadcaster TF1. "I can't find the words. It's just extraordinary. It was one of my dreams."

France is looking for a third World Cup title and is among the favorites for the event taking place from June 11-July 19 in Canada, Mexico, and the United States.

France has been drawn in Group I and will take on Senegal, Iraq and Norway during the group stage.

Deschamps is gifted with an impressive attacking reservoir including Kylian Mbappé, Ballon d'Or winner Ous-

mane Dembélé, rising star Désiré Doué, Michael Olise, Rayan Cherki and Maghnes Aklouché.

He also called up Crystal Palace forward Jean-Philippe Mateta, who was preferred to Randal Kolo Muani in his 26-man list. The Tottenham striker had been a late addition to France's previous World Cup squad four years ago. Kolo Muani scored a goal against Morocco in the semifinals and came close of becoming a national hero in the final before France lost to Argentina in a penalty shootout.

Among those missing out are Real Madrid midfielder Eduardo Camavinga and PSG goalkeeper Lucas Chevalier, who lost his starting spot to Matvey Safonov at the club and has not played since the end of January. AGENCIES

Mbappe says Arbeloa has him as 4th-choice striker, coach denies claim

MADRID: Kylian Mbappé said after not starting in Real Madrid's Spanish league soccer match against Oviedo on Thursday that coach Alvaro Arbeloa told him that he is the team's fourth-choice striker.

Arbeloa appeared to be caught by surprise by Mbappé's words and said he never told him that. He said he doesn't know why Mbappé felt like that.

Mbappé, who had been nursing a left hamstring injury, said he was ready to play from the start against Oviedo but Arbeloa decided not to use him.

"I'm 100% fine," Mbappé said. "I didn't play because the coach told me I'm the fourth striker in the squad behind (Franco) Mastantuono, Vini (Vinicius Júnior) and Gonzalo (García). I accept it. I was ready



Kylian Mbappe on the bench against Oviedo

AP

to start, it was his decision. You can't be angry with the coach, you always have to respect the opinion of the coach. I'll keep working hard and wait to be the starter."

Arbeloa later said he never told Mbappé he was the fourth striker in the squad.

"I don't have four strikers, and I haven't told anything like that to Mbappé," Arbeloa said.

The disagreement between Arbeloa and Mbappé is the latest in a chaotic week for Madrid

"He probably didn't understand me. I don't really know what to tell you. I wouldn't tell him that he's the fourth-choice striker."

The disagreement between Arbeloa and Mbappé is the latest in a chaotic week for Madrid, which started with an altercation between players in training that led the club to fine Federico Valverde and Auré-

lien Tchouaméni 500,000 euros each. Then came the 2-0 loss to Barcelona in the clasico on Sunday that allowed its rival to clinch the league title. On Tuesday, an edgy Madrid president Florentino Pérez called for new elections after saying he was the victim of an "organized campaign" to unseat him.

Mbappé was booed by the crowd at the Santiago Bernabeu stadium after coming into the match to replace Garcia in the 68th minute. He assisted in Jude Bellingham's 79th-minute goal that sealed Madrid's 2-0 win. The France star had been criticized by some fans who claimed he was saving himself for the World Cup. During his time off because of the injury, Mbappé reportedly traveled to Italy with actress Ester Expósito, prompting criticism in Spanish media. AGENCIES



New Khlia Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, NOIDA-201301 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes / amendments & corrigendum etc.
A) Fresh-Tender Work :-

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1.	60/GM/SM(WC-5)/2026-2027	Village Development (Providing and fixing and repair of culvert Jaal in Village-Chaura), Noida.	14.39
2.	78/GM/SM(WC-5)/2026-2027	M/o Road (C/o road and drain from BS-72 to 78 in 5% Abadi Plots, DBM & BC work and P/F SFRC Cover in Sector-70), Noida.	24.67

The above Tenders can be uploaded from dated 18.05.2026 to 01.06.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 02.06.2026 at 11.00 AM.

B) Re-Tender Work :-

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the Work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
3.	58/GM/SM (WC-2)/ET/ 2025-26	Strengthening of Road (P/L DBM & BC, D & C Block Internal Road road Sector-20), Noida.	28.46
4.	07/GM/SM(E&M-III)/2025-26	Annual Operation and routine Maintenance of Electrical Equipment such as L.T. Panel, CCTV Camera, ISTMS Equipment at Command Control Centre Sector-94, Noida.	14.28
5.	33/DGM/SM (WC-2)/ET/ 2025-26	D/o Village and Maintenance (C/o culvert & M.S. Jaal and other Misc. work over Drain at different location in Village Nithari Sector-31), Noida.	19.48
6.	05/GM/SM(WC-1)/2025-26	M/o Building (Construction of Toilet near Gate No.-5 in Sector-55), Noida.	23.27

The above Tenders can be uploaded from dated 18.05.2026 to 25.05.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 26.05.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ayush Kumar, S/o Suraj Singh R/o 238, Jalan Mohalla, Tuglakabad, Vill. Jaitpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 202/2024, u/s 279/337 IPC, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ayush Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ayush Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ayush Kumar of FIR No. 202/2024, u/s 279/337 IPC, P.S. Rajouri Garden, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
West, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/6362/WD/2026



M.P. TEXTBOOK CORPORATION
"Pustak Bhawan" Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011
Tel. : 0755-2551565, E-mail : info.mptbc@mp.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER FOR INSURANCE OF STOCK OF TEXTBOOKS, OTHER BOOKS/ MATERIAL & PAPER
E-Tenders are invited on prescribed bid forms for insurance of stock of textbooks, other books/ material & stock of paper from Insurance Companies registered with Insurance Regulatory & Development Authority.
Tenders and their details etc. can be seen on e-tendering portal-<https://mptenders.gov.in> from 16:00 hrs. on 18.05.2026.
Tender documents can be downloaded from 17:00 hrs on 18.05.2026 and online technical and commercial bid can be submitted before 10:30 hrs on 09.06.2026 Contact on mobile No-9340520914/8269228947 and help desk Telephone No. 0120-4001002, 0120-4001005 for online registration or tender details.
All above details and corrigendum/amendments (if any) would be published only on portal <https://mptenders.gov.in>
M.P. Madhyam/125794/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kaushal Kumar Jha S/o Sh. Digambar Jha R/o P-54, Pillanji Village, Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi & Village & Post-Khanghor, PS Babu Bari, Distt Madhubani, Bihar** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 202/2018 U/S 380/511 IPC, PS Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Kaushal Kumar Jha** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Kaushal Kumar Jha** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Kaushal Kumar Jha of FIR No. 202/2018 U/S 380/511 IPC, PS Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **30.06.2026**

By Order,
Ms. Vijayshree Rathore
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Court No. 13, First Floor, Main Building
DP/6049/SW/2026 (Court Matter) **Patiala House Court, New Delhi**

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM
Ref: i) Tender Notice No. 05/2026-2027 dated 21.04.2026.
ii) Tender No.08260001A due on 25.05.2026.
1. In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from **15.05.2026 to 25.05.2026**. All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.
The Corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in
1632/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
SEE SECTION 84 BHARATIYA NAGARIK SURAKSHA SANHITA
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vikram @ Vicky S/o Jaipal R/o H. No. 640, Gali No. 14, Station Block, Kirari, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 144/24 u/s 20 NDPS Act at P.S. Prem Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Vikram @ Vicky** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Vikram @ Vicky** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vikram @ Vicky** accused of FIR No. 144/24 u/s 20 NDPS Act at P.S. Prem Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **31.08.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Shagun,
Judicial Magistrate First Class, (North-West)
Room No. 109, 1st Floor,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/6338/RD/2026

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय
पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर
लापता: आवश्यक सूचना



गुमशुदा शकुफता परवीन, उम्र-करीब 28 वर्ष
सर्व साधारण को सूचित करना है कि गुमशुदा शकुफता परवीन, उम्र-करीब 28 वर्ष, पिता-मो0 इरफान, पिता-रोड 40-04, वारिस कोलोनो स्थित नूर के घर में किसयंदार, थाना- आजादनगर, जिला-पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर जो दिनांक- 26.04.2026 को संख्या समय करीब 03:30 बजे अपने घर से निकली है अभी तक वापस नहीं लौटी है। आवेदक एवं इनके परिवारवालों ने अपने स्तर से काफी खोजबीन किया परन्तु कुछ पता नहीं चल सका। गुमशुदा महिला का इलिया निम्न प्रकार है - उम्र-करीब 28 वर्ष, रंग-सांवला, ऊँचाई-05 फीट, पहनावा-हर रंग का बुरखा, भाषा-हिन्दी, उर्दू एवं अंग्रेजी।
अतः आप सभी जैन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि उपरोक्त गुमशुदा के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती हो तो इसकी सूचना वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।
वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर : 0657-2431006
पुलिस अधीक्षक (नगर), पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर : 9471190203
पुलिस उपधीक्षक, (पटमरा), पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर : 9431706496
थाना प्रभारी, आजादनगर : 9431706502
वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंढूम, जमशेदपुर

PR 379871 Police(26-27).D
POLICE HELPLINE (EMERGENCY DIAL)-112 CHILD HELPLINE-1098
WOMEN HELPLINE-1091 DOMESTIC ABUSE HELPLINE-181
CYBER CRIME HELPLINE-1930 AMBULANCE SERVICE-108



UJVN LIMITED
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135-2763508, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001ISGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

प.सं. 416 **दिनांक: 15.05.2026**

Corrigendum-01
e-tender No-04/EE(E&M)/Ichari dam/2026-27 invited by the office of Executive Engineer (E&M) Ichari dam dakpathar for the work of SITC of discharge monitoring system at down stream for strengthening of EWS and for e-flow monitoring of Ichari dam dist. Dehradun, has been amended and uploaded on the website in Section(4) of the technical Specification Documents. Other conditions of the tender will remain the same. For detailed information, please visit the e-procurement portal "<https://uktenders.gov.in>"
Executive Engineer (E&M) Ichari Dam
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL), CSPGCL
Shed No. 11, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2574562, website www.cspc.co.in E-mail:- civilprojectcmg@gmail.com
No.04-04/W/260 Raipur, date 12.05.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from contractors registered in appropriate class in CSPGCL in three-part tendering system. The unregistered contractor having experience in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Local bodies/Power Generating Companies in India only may be considered on submission of experience certificate for following work as mentioned below:-

Tender Specifi. No.	Name of Work	NIT value
CEC/HTTPS-KW/W/2026 19	Providing and fixing profile sheet replacing to damage corrugated A.C. sheet at Conveyor 5AB, 10A & 10B, 9A & 9B of INT CHP at 4x210MW, HTPS, CSPGCL, Korba West E-Comp.No.-311544	81.70 Lacs

Note:- (i) The detailed NIT, Eligibility Criteria, Tender document & other details can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal>. (ii) NIT value is inclusive of GST @ 18%. Chief Engineer (Civil) CSPGCL, Raipur

SAVE ELECTRICITY **samvad 47830/1**



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E- Tender Notice
Tender Notice No. - Dy.CPM/GSU/PRYJ/19/2026 Date: 09.05.2026
Dy. Chief Project Manager/Gati Shakti Unit/Prayagraj, North Central Railway, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders for the following work through Open Tender-Two Packet System with closing date/time **02.06.2026** up to 15:00 hours. Bidders will be able to submit their original / revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored:-
Tender No.: GSU/19, Name of work:- Provision of 12M wide FOB at GMC yard regarding development of GMC as satellite station.
Approx. cost of work (Rs.): Rs. 106042084.11 Earnest money (Rs.): Rs. 2120900.00
Completion Period:- 08 Months Date of Opening of tender:- 02.06.2026, 15:00 hrs.
Similar work for eligibility criteria:- Fabrication and erection of steel structure or launching /de-launching of steel girder.
Note: Tender on line can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on 02.06.2026, 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-tender are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 02.06.2026, 1092/26 (D)
North central railways **CPRONCR** **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in**



ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd, 4/10, Mythree Tower, Bommanahalli Hosur Main Road Bangalore- 560068

PUBLIC NOTICE
The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA).
A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

Sr.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Saravanan C/ Door No 38/3 Plot No 3a, Block No.25 Ward A 300m From Oht Earika, Oragadam Village Ambattur, S No 16/3 Part TS No 43, Chennai Chennai- 600053/ LBCE00007269384 & TBCE00007267636	All That Piece And Parcel of Land Building Bearing Door No.38/3, Plot No.3A, Situate In Oragadam Village, Bharathidasan Street, Venkateshwara Nagar, Comprised In S.No.43, As Per New Patto No.644, T.S.No.43, Block.No.25, Ward-A, To An Extent of 1260 Sq.ft. Within The Local Limits of Chennai Corporation, Within The Revenue District of Chennai And Ambattur Taluk, In The Registration District of Chennai-North And Sub-Registration District of Ambattur And Bounded On The North By: Shanmugam Land South By: 20 Feet Road East By: Plot No.4 West By: Plot No.3 Measuring East To West On The Northern Side: 30 Feet East To West On The Southern Side: 30 Feet North To South On The Eastern Side: 42 Feet North To South On The Western Side: 42 Feet In Total 1260 Sq.ft of Land And Building Thereon With Electricity Connection.	April 06, 2026 Rs. 15,57,809.23/-	21/02/ 2026

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower(s) and/or guarantor(s) (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.
Date: May 16, 2026
Place: Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.



Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Branch : Chawri Bazar 3462, Gali Bajrangbali Chawri Bazar, Delhi-110006 India
Tel : 011-23260795 E-mail : chawri@jkbmail.com W : www.jkbank.net

POSSESSION NOTICE
Notice under Section 13 (4) of the SARFAESI ACT, 2002 read with Rule 8 (1) of the Security (Enforcement) Interest Rules, 2002
Whereas Rohit Mahajan, as the Authorized Officer of the Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers under section 13(2) of the said Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notice dated 23.02.2026 thereby calling upon the Borrower namely Manya International Prop. Bharat Bhushan Singhal S/o Mr. Brij Bhushan Singhal to repay an amount of **Rs. 39,90,903.20 (Rupees Thirty nine lacs ninety thousand nine hundred three and paise twenty only)** being the balance outstanding as on 02.02.2026 in the accounts of the Borrower, within 60 days from the date of the said notice together with the future interest and other charges thereon.
The said borrower having failed to repay the said amount, notice is hereby given to the said borrower in particular and the public in general that the undersigned being authorized officer of the J & K Bank Ltd. has taken possession of the mortgage property described herein below, in exercise of the powers conferred on me under section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules, on this **12th day of month May of the year 2026**.
The said borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned against dealing with the said property in any manner whatsoever and any dealings with the said property will be subject to the charge of the J&K Bank Limited for the amount in aggregating to **Rs. 39,90,903.20 (Rupees Thirty nine lacs ninety thousand nine hundred three and paise twenty only)** together with future interest thereon from 01.02.2026 and other charges incurred or to be incurred.
The borrowers attention is invited to the provisions of Sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of the time available, to redeem the secured assets.
a) Hypothecation of all kinds of stocks and book debts.
Description of the Immoveable Property
(As per the schedule provided in mortgage deed/latest particulars including any accreditations)
b) One shop on first floor bearing pvt. no. 6, without roof rights measuring 37.42 sq. mts. approx., being part of built up property bearing MPL no. 3103-3104 situated at ward no VI, Mohalla Dassan, Charkhewalan, Chawri Bazar, Delhi 110006 and common rights to use the main entrance, passage and stairs along with proportionate rights of freehold land underneath standing in the name of Mrs. Saroj Singhal. This property is also mortgaged in cash credit facility of Rs. 50.00 lacs in favour of M/s B R Enterprises prop. Brij Bhushan Singhal.
c) Two shops on first floor bearing pvt. no. 3103-3104/3 & 4, without roof rights measuring 475 sq. ft. being part of built up property bearing MPL no. 3103-3104 situated at ward no. VI, Mohalla Dassan, Charkhewalan, Chawri Bazar, Delhi with undivided, undivisible, impartible, proportionate shares of ownership in land under said building standing in the name of Mrs. Saroj Singhal. This property is also mortgaged in cash credit facility of Rs. 50.00 lacs in favour of M/s B R Enterprises prop. Brij Bhushan Singhal.
d) One shop bearing pvt. no. 9 on Ground Floor without roof/terrace rights being a part of property bearing MC No. 3164 situated at ward no. VI Phatak Nanak Chand, Mohalla Dassan, Hauz Qazi, Delhi measuring 9.10 sq. mtrs. along with proportionate rights of the land underneath standing in the name of Brij Bhushan Singhal already mortgaged in cash credit facility of Rs. 50.00 lacs under account no. 0274020140000051 of M/s B R Enterprises.
Date : 12.05.2026
Place : Chawri Bazar **Authorized Officer**
Registered office Corporate Headquarters M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001 Kashmir, India T +91 (0)194 2481 930-35 F +91 (0)194 248 1928
CIN: L65110JK1938SGC000048 E- info@jkbmail.com W www.jkbank.net



NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Name of work and its location : 82-SRDEE-G-DL-2026-27
Electrical work in connection with, (i) Provision of Pk-line for the maintenance of NMG rakes at TKD Yard. (ii) Setting up of Bio Toilet Testing Lab in coaching depot at JHI.
Approx. cost of the works in : Rs. 1,28,41,646.00/-
Address of the office : Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money : Rs. 2,56,800.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender : 08.06.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender : 08.06.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board : www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE **1626/2026**



UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O. "UJJWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CIN No. U40101UR2001ISGC025866
Tele: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.418 **Time Extension Notice** **Date: 15.05.2026**
Due to unavoidable circumstances, the last date for submission of the below-mentioned tender invited by Executive Engineer (Gen), Tiloth Power House, Uttarkashi, is hereby extended as follows:
1. Tender No. 01/EE(G)/TPH/2026-27for Renewal of ABT Metering (E-Watch) System software, Data Synchronization with SLDC, and Supply of Communication & Networking Equipment for Tiloth Power House & Heena Sub Station.
2. Tender No.04/EE(G)/TPH/2026-27 for Annual Maintenance Contract of CCTV surveillance system at Tiloth Power House, Uttarkashi.
Last date for downloading bid -22.05.2026 up to 16:00 hrs. document from website
Last date of submission of documents : 26.05.2026 up to 15:00 hrs. in original (hard copy)
Date of opening of bids: 26.05.2026 up to 15:30 hrs.
All other terms & conditions will remain unchanged. For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website www.ujvnl.com
Executive Engineer (Generation)
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"



APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immoveable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immoveable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immoveable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 17.06.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M. for recovery of Rs. 30,72,913/- (Rupees Thirty Lakh Seventy Two Thousand Nine Hundred Thirteen only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDMT00357714, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 07.05.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 08.05.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from NARESH KUMAR GUPTA, SAMPAT RAM AGGARWAL and SAVITRI DEVI.
The Reserve Price of the Immoveable Property will be Rs. 9,10,000/- (Rupees Nine Lakh Ten Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 91,00,00/- (Rupees Ninety One Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. SF - 3 (L I. G.), HAVING COVERED AREA OF 37.16 SQ. MTR. ON 2ND FLOOR, REAR LHS BACK SIDE, SITUATED ON PLOT NO. A - 113, BLOCK - A, KHASRA NO. 392 & 393, S. L. F. VED VIHAR, HADABAST VILLAGE SADULLABAD, PARGANA LOHI, TEHSIL & DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201001, UTTAR PRADESH, ALONG WITH ROOF RIGHTS. THE PROPERTY IS BOUNDED AS UNDER:
EAST : COMMON PASSAGE AND FLAT NO. S. F. - 4
WEST : PLOT NO. A - 114
NORTH : PLOT NO. A - 100
SOUTH : FLAT NO. S. F. - 2
For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.
ad-
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Ravi Kumar S/o: Sh Brij Mohan, R/o: 28/02, MCD Jheel Colony, Model Town, Phase-3, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 645/2021, Dt. 11.11.2021, U/s: 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS: Adarsh Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Ravi Kumar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Ravi Kumar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Ravi Kumar, of FIR No. 645/2021, Dt. 11.11.2021, U/s: 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS: Adarsh Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint

By Order
Kuljeevan Sidharth
Additional Sessions Judge (Electricity),
North West Court No. 316
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/6294/NW/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: 05/2026 **Date: 13.05.2026**
E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
Tender No.: 13265198A **E.M.D. (Rs.): ₹ 179350/-**
Description: Main LED signal lamps (YELLOW Aspect)
Qty.: 1076 Nos. **Tender Opening Date: 23.06.2026**

Note:- (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender are available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>, (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against Above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. (5) Allocation for "Cost of Drawing" is Z-650 and for "Earnest Money deposit (EMD)" is Deposit Misc. stores -00844517. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. **1097/26 (A)**

North central railways **CPRONCR** **www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in**



NORTHERN RAILWAY
(E-Auction Notice)
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<http://ireps.gov.in>) for the allotment of Deluxe Pay & Use Toilet Contracts on RMT & MOT basis, at following Railway stations/Locations:

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
PaynUse-5-2026	01.06.2026 को 12:00 बजे	Hazrat Nizamuddin (NZM) 03 Sites, Panipat (PNP) 01 Site, Patel Nagar (PTNR) 01 Site, Delhi Sarai Rohilla (DEE) 01 Site, Anand Vihar (ANVT) 01 Site & Delhi (DLI) 01 Site Total 08 Sites.

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen. <https://ireps.gov.in/>

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfill following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids: • Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. • The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. • Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender/E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: sanitationcell@gmail.com , Tel: 011-23743084
--	---

No. 7PUB/TN/Pay&UseToilets/Auction/2022 Dated: 14.05.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE **1621/26**

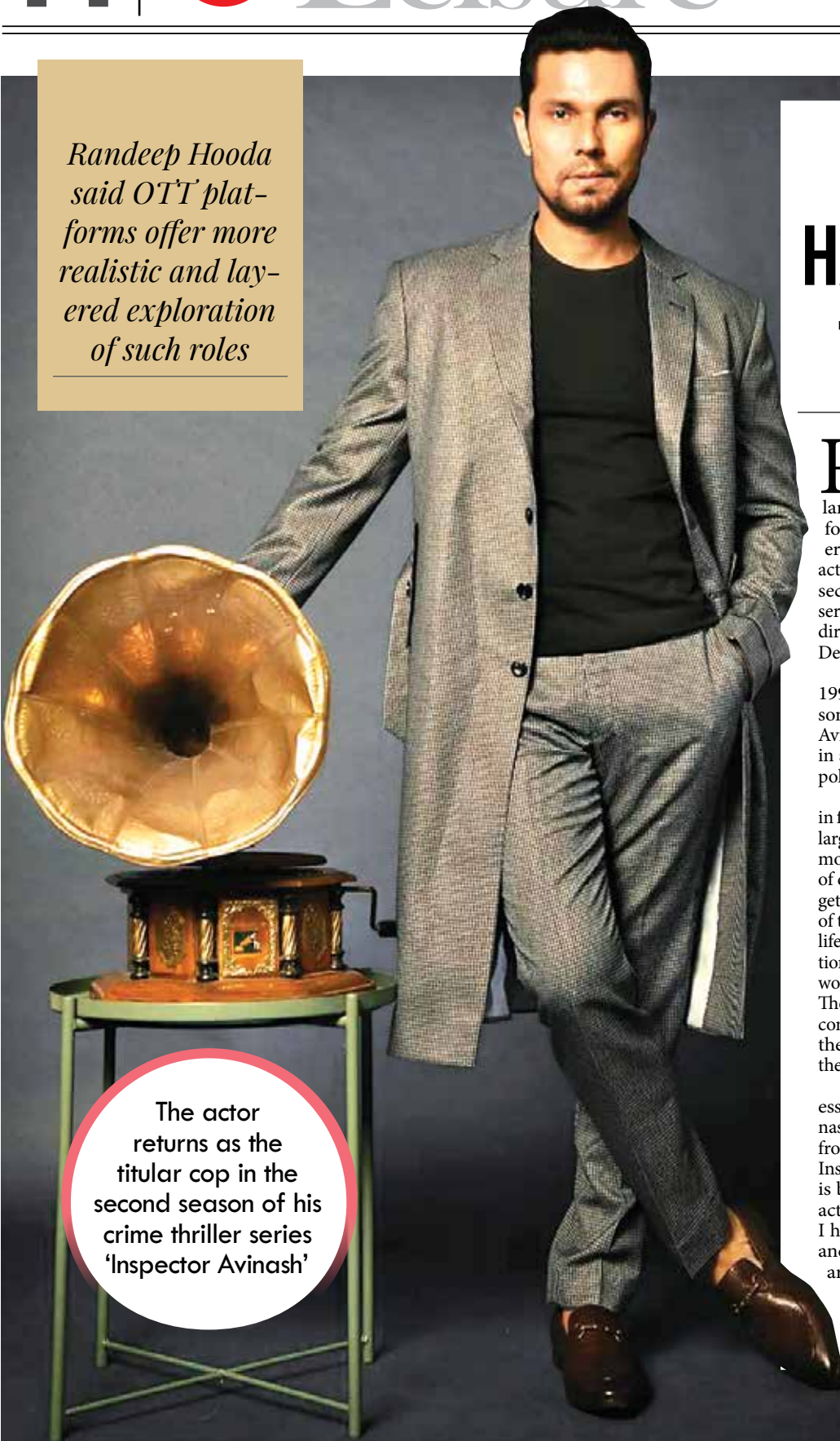
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPc/84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Saroj Singh S/o Inderchand Singh R/o H. No. 25-B, Tek Chand Wali Gali, Village Sannoth, Delhi & Village Muradabad Khurd, Distt. Sasaram, Bihar** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 439/21, U/S 323/341/307/34 IPC, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Saroj Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Saroj Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Saroj Singh of FIR No. 439/21, U/S 323/341/307/34 IPC, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **03.07.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North, Court No.06, 1st Floor
DP/5818/ON/2026(Court Matter) **Rohini Courts, Delhi**



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice **Date: 12.05.2026**
Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.
E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-47-26 **Approx Cost : Rs. 19196718.43/-**
Description of work : Provision of S&T work in connection with longer loop on 3rd line at Burhpura and Mohasa Stations of Jhansi division.
Earnest Money : Rs. 3839900.00/- **Cost of Tender form : Nil**
Opening of tender : 04.06.2026 Time 15:00
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months
• Tender on line can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 04.06.2026.
• For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) **1084/26 (D)**
North central railways **CPRONCR</**

Randeep Hooda said OTT platforms offer more realistic and layered exploration of such roles



The actor returns as the titular cop in the second season of his crime thriller series 'Inspector Avinash'

'COP CHARACTERS HAVE TURNED LARGER-THAN-LIFE IN FILMS'

Randeep Hooda said a lot of cop characters in films have become stereotypical and larger than life, while OTT platforms offer more realistic and layered exploration of such roles. The actor returns as the titular cop in the second season of his crime thriller series 'Inspector Avinash'. The show is directed by Neeraj Pathak of Sunny Deol-starrer 'Bhaiaji Superhit' fame.

Set in the volatile landscape of 1990s Uttar Pradesh, the new season raises the intensity as Inspector Avinash Mishra finds himself caught in a storm that is as personal as it is political.

"A lot of our cop characters lately in films have been very caricature-ish, larger than life. That's also a genre of movie. It's somebody else's expression of doing it. But in the OTT space, we get more time to deal with other parts of the police officer's life or anybody's life in terms of their family, their relationship with the different people they work with; it gives it a more real touch. There are many great pieces that have come out, which are all different from the others describing the plight of these people," Hooda told PTI.

Hood feels fortunate to have essayed the role of Inspector Avinash, who is based on a real-life cop from Uttar Pradesh. "I know the real Inspector Avinash Mishra as well. It is by far one of my favourite characters and the most fun characters I have played, though the situations and the kind of crime that he is in are quite severe. But the way he deals with it and how he speaks, carries himself, how he is with his team, family and criminals;



it is very entertaining and interesting," he said.

Despite portraying a real-life character, Hooda believes an actor can still bring a new dimension to the role. "As an actor, when you imbue yourself with somebody else's thought process and physicality, then your own touch also makes it a bit special and that's what is unique about our work as a whole that we create," he added.

Hooda is no stranger to portraying real-life figures, having previously starred in films such as 'Sarbjit', 'Rang Rasiya', 'Main Aur Charles' and 'Swatantrya Veer Savarkar'. "I don't know whether I have the formula for that, but I have been very fortunate to have these roles. Whenever you get to play any real-life characters, it becomes easier and difficult at the same time. Easier in the sense that you have a defined boundary for that person and difficult because you have to get it right without trying to imitate them, but still trying to embody them," he said.

'Inspector Avinash' also features Urvashi Rautela, Amit Sial, Abhimanyu Singh, Rajneesh Duggal, Shalin Bhanot and Freddy Daruwala in pivotal roles. The show's second season is currently streaming on 'Jio-Hotstar'.

PTI



Amazon MGM begins hunt for next James Bond

The film's creative team is already in place

The search for the next James Bond is officially underway, with 'Amazon MGM Studios' auditioning actors to fill the role of Ian Fleming's iconic British secret agent 007. According to 'Variety', the studio has hired acclaimed casting director Nina Gold to find a successor to Daniel Craig. The new actor will headline one of global cinema's most enduring franchises with a screen history stretching back to 1962.

"The search for the next James Bond is underway. While we don't plan to comment on specific details during the casting process, we're excited to share more news with 007 fans as soon as the time is right," 'Amazon MGM Studios' said in a statement to the outlet.

Gold, one of Hollywood's most sought-after casting directors, is best known for her work on HBO's 'Game of Thrones', Netflix's 'The Crown' and five films in the 'Star Wars' franchise. She has also done casting for critically acclaimed films 'Les Misérables', 'The Martian' and 'Conclave' and received an Oscar nomination for her work on 'Hamnet', in 2025, the first year the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences introduced an award for casting.

The film's creative team is already in place. Denis Villeneuve, the acclaimed French-Canadian director of 'Dune', 'Dune: Part Two', 'Blade Runner

The studio has hired acclaimed casting director Nina Gold to find a successor to Daniel Craig

2049' and 'Arrival', will helm the project from a script by 'Peaky Blinders' scribe Steven Knight. Amy Pascal and David Heyman will produce, with Villeneuve's wife and creative partner Tanya Lapointe serving as executive producer.

The upcoming project, tentatively called 'Bond 26', will be the first James Bond movie to be developed by 'Amazon MGM' since the banner completed its acquisition of 'MGM Studios' in 2022. Last year, 'Amazon MGM' announced a landmark joint venture with longtime Bond producers Barbara Broccoli and Michael G Wilson, gaining creative control of the iconic franchise.

Villeneuve, who has been a longtime fan of the '007' franchise, is currently completing 'Dune: Messiah', his third and final film in the 'Dune' saga, slated for release in December 2026. Bond pre-production is expected to begin thereafter.

Craig played 007 in 'Casino Royale' (2006), 'Quantum of Solace' (2008), 'Skyfall' (2012), 'Spectre' (2015) and 'No Time to Die' (2021).

PTI

Vishal Bhardwaj & Shaunak Sen to mentor indie filmmakers

Acclaimed filmmakers Vishal Bhardwaj and Shaunak Sen have stepped forward as mentors to empower India's next generation of independent directors. 'Humans of Cinema' and 'Safarnaama Pictures' have launched a feature film co-production fund of Rs 40 lakh, designed to back an emerging filmmaker with a distinct voice and a clear vision.

Bhardwaj and Sen have joined the initiative as mentors and the latter is also attached as an executive producer in one of the films. The fund is open to all Indian citizens aged 18 and above who have directed at least two short films or one feature film.

Bhardwaj, the director of critical hits such as 'Maqbool', 'Omkaara', 'Kaminey' and 'Haider', said he is delighted to lend his support to the budding filmmakers in the country. "Independent cinema survives because some people choose to believe in voices before the world discovers them. I'm happy to support an initiative that hopes to find and nurture the next fearless generation of filmmakers from India," the filmmaker said.

Sen, known for directing the Oscar-nominated documentary 'All That Breathes', added, "Avenues for independent cinema today are rapidly wilting and I'm delighted that 'Humans of Cinema' is instituting a filmmaker-forward seed fund. I'm excited to work with the chosen scripts."

Harshit Bansal, Founder

of 'Humans of Cinema', said the idea for the fund took shape when Nazim Momin of 'Safarnaama Pictures', a US-based engineer and producer, reached out via Instagram with a shared vision to back independent Indian cinema. He said they will not only help filmmakers with the financial and industry support needed to make their films but also help them find the right festival and distribution support.

Bhardwaj is delighted to lend his support to the budding filmmakers in the country

"We feel fortunate that Shaunak Sen and Vishal Bhardwaj have joined our initiative as mentors. Their support and insights will be invaluable for the selected filmmaker as well as us. We're also grateful to Shaunak's production company, 'Kiterabbit Films', for offering us crucial support for this initiative and to our jury members who are lending their expertise out of sheer goodwill and a passion to support good cinema," Bansal added.

The jury for the fund includes actor Imran Khan, filmmaker Arati Kadav, who garnered wide acclaim for her films 'Cargo' and 'Mrs', producer Aman Mann and renowned author and festival director Aseem Chhabra. PTI



Alia Bhatt reacts to trolls over her Cannes Film Festival video

Alia Bhatt responded to a troll claiming she went unnoticed at the Cannes Film Festival. She attended the prestigious film festival for the second time, following her debut in 2025. As the videos from the red carpet went viral on the internet, a section of users pointed out that the actress was ignored by the paparazzi.

Responding to the same, the actress wrote, "Why pity love? You noticed me."

One of the videos featured the actor standing in front of the photographers, who noticeably lowered their cameras. The users online were divided, with some defending the actress and others turning to troll her, claiming she isn't recognised at the international level.

Earlier, Bhatt shared a series of pictures and videos from the festival. While several users left compliments under the post, one went to write, "What a pity, no one noticed you." Responding to the same, the



actress, who is attending the festival as India's global ambassador for 'LOreal Paris', wrote, "Why pity love? You noticed me."

PTI

JACK RYAN: GHOST WAR

John talks about reprising Jack Ryan

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The beloved 'Ryanverse' is officially back, for this time, it's going bigger, bolder and more cinematic than ever before. After winning the hearts of audiences around the world with the fan-favourite series Tom Clancy's 'Jack Ryan' across four seasons, John Krasinski is reprising the iconic role in Prime Video's highly anticipated action-thriller, 'Jack Ryan: Ghost War'.

Marking the franchise's exciting evolution from a series into a full-scale feature film, 'Ghost War' promises edge-of-the-seat action, larger stakes and a mission more dangerous than anything Jack has faced before. For Krasinski himself, stepping back into the character's shoes this time felt more exhilarating than ever.

Sharing his experience of returning to the high-stakes world of Jack Ryan, he said, "It feels amazing. Honestly, I think this is the most fun I've ever had playing the role. It's been a totally different experience. The show was a different kind of storytelling; it was long-form and took longer to shoot. With the movie, we feel like



Directed by Andrew Bernstein, with a story by Noah Oppenheim and John Krasinski, 'Jack Ryan: Ghost War' premieres on May 20 exclusively on 'Prime Video'

people know the characters and we were able to have more fun with the traditional three-act structure."

Reflecting on what continues to

draw him towards the character, Krasinski added, "I always loved the idea that a Jack Ryan existed, that there was somebody who was human and decent and real out there on the front lines, being a true hero rather than someone with a cape or with superpowers. It's inspiring."

In 'Jack Ryan: Ghost War', Jack is reluctantly thrust back into the dangerous world of espionage after an international covert mission uncovers a deadly conspiracy. As the clock ticks and global threats intensify, Jack reunites with trusted CIA operative Mike November and former CIA boss James Greer while joining forces with sharp MI6 officer Emma Marlowe.

VIMAL KHANNA: THE NEXT SURVIVAL THRILLER OBSESSION

Here are five reasons why the new series should be on everyone's watchlist

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Amazon MX Player brings to screen 'Vimal Khanna', a gripping survival thriller set in the iconic universe of 'The Vimal Series', created by Surendra Mohan Pathak. Starring Sunny Hinduja alongside Isha Talwar and Tara Alisha Berry, the series follows Vimal Khanna, a man forced on the run after being falsely accused and stripped of his identity.

As he fights to reclaim his life, he is pulled into a dangerous world of betrayal, shifting loyalties and hidden motives, where every step only drags him deeper into the chaos. With its emotional intensity and gritty storytelling, 'Vimal Khanna' builds a tense, high-stakes world where survival becomes the only way forward.

Here are five reasons why 'Vimal Khanna' should be on your watchlist:

The Screen Adaptation of an Iconic Literary Universe

Long before crime thrillers



became the backbone of mainstream on OTT, readers across the country were hooked to the gritty, fast-paced world of Surendra Mohan Pathak's 'The Vimal Series'. Vimal Khanna revives that iconic universe with a sharp, cinematic lens, retaining its raw edge while introducing the world to a whole new generation of viewers.

Sunny Hinduja Steps into a Fan-Favourite Character

Bringing years of reader imagination to the screen, Sunny Hinduja takes on the role of Vimal Khanna with intensity and emotional depth.

Starring Sunny Hinduja alongside Isha Talwar and Tara Alisha Berry, the series follows Vimal Khanna, a man forced on the run after being falsely accused and stripped of his identity

His performance captures the transformation of an ordinary man caught in extraordinary circumstances, constantly balancing fear, resilience and survival.

"Kaun Hai Vimal?" Becomes the Show's Biggest Mystery

At the heart of the series lies

one powerful question: "Main kaun hoon?" Framed, erased and forced into hiding, Vimal's fight is no longer just about proving innocence. It becomes a desperate attempt to reclaim his identity before the system permanently rewrites his life. That emotional conflict gives the thriller its real punch.

A Powerful Ensemble Drives the World of Vimal Khanna

The world of Vimal Khanna is packed with shifting loyalties and layered tension. Bringing together a strong ensemble cast featuring Isha Talwar and Tara Alisha Berry adds unpredictability and emotional complexity to the narrative, constantly blurring the line between ally and threat. Nobody feels completely trustworthy and that paranoia keeps the tension alive throughout.

Watch Vimal Khanna for Free on 'Amazon MX Player'

With its gritty atmosphere, emotional stakes and survival-thriller energy, the series delivers a binge-worthy ride built for fans of high-stakes storytelling. Vimal Khanna is now streaming for free on 'Amazon MX Player' across the 'MX Player' app, 'Amazon' shopping app, 'Prime Video', 'Fire TV' and connected TVs, making the world of Vimal Khanna easily accessible to audiences everywhere.